

BLEED AI · COMPETITOR INTELLIGENCE

Competitor Strategy — the 12-Creator Teardown

Full reverse-engineering of every top cold-email / outbound creator we scraped: end-to-end strategy, top-10 AND worst-10 posts (with links + the why of each), content pillars, contrarian takes, what works, what flops, and what to steal for Taha.

Built from a 6,642-post corpus via 12 research agents. Living document — regenerated from `playbook/COMPETITORS-STRATEGY.md`; the same Drive link updates in place.

Competitors Strategy — the full teardown of every scraped creator

Deep, per-creator intelligence on all 12 operators in our corpus ([campaign-master/knowledge-base/learning-center](#)), reverse-engineered from their real posts (ranked by likes; comments/shares where available). For each: end-to-end strategy, top-5 content pillars, top-10 posts (analytics + template + topic + hook + structure + tone), top-5 contrarian takes, what differentiates them, what works, what flops, what they avoid, and what to steal for Taha. Built 2026-07-14 via 12 parallel research agents. **The decided Bleed AI strategy this feeds lives in [STRATEGY.md](#).**

Data note: [eric-nowoslawski](#) had no LinkedIn scrape in the corpus — only YouTube — so that report is ranked by video views.

★ THE SYNTHESIS — what all 12 prove, and the path Taha should stick on

Read this first. The individual reports are the evidence; this is the verdict.

The scoreboard (at a glance)

Creator	Scale / who	Median likes	#1 mechanic	Contrarian wedge	Archetype	Steal-priority for Taha
kenny-damian	ColdIQ Head of GTM, \$7M ARR	78	comment-gate → DM repo/skill	signals > SDRs, tier your signals	Systems/AI	★★★★★
sacha-martinot	ColdIQ builder	47	comment-gate → DM Notion doc	build tools not prompts	Systems/AI	★★★★★
outboundphd / eric	Growth Engine X, Clay partner	84 (LI)	comment-gate + free repo	throw domains away, kill AI perso	Systems/AI (engineer)	★★★★★
michel-lieben	ColdIQ founder, \$7M ARR	273	comment-gate + P.S. pitch	"agent" = clever workflow; data > copy	Systems/agency-flex	★★★★★
nick-abraham	Leadbird, 2M emails/mo	53	comment "EMAIL" (must connect)	fundamentals > tool-flexing	Operator	★★★★★
atishay-hyperke	Hyperke, 20M emails	21	reusable AI-Gem, re-dropped	relevance > personalization	Deliverability/scale	★★★★★
richard-illingworth	Premium Inboxes, 250k inboxes	17	comment + connect → DM SOP	it's infra, not your copy	Deliverability	★★★
nikita-maildoso	Maildoso CEO (SMTP)	33	free-inbox giveaway + connect	SMTP > Google (incentive conspiracy)	Founder/category	★★★
aidan-collins	LinkedIn lead-gen agency	14	comment KEYWORD + connect	packaging > the resource	LinkedIn-native	★★★ (mechanic only)
josh-braun	Sales trainer	56	value-inside-post (soft)	stop convincing; anti-pushiness	Psychology/story	★★★★★
charles-tenot	lemlist growth exec	130	debate-prompt (soft)	CRO > CEO; timing > volume	Operator-philosopher	★★★★★

(michel + charles show the highest medians because they sell aspiration/worldview; the AI-systems operators show the highest ceilings on breakout posts. Taha's lane fuses both.)

The ONE mechanic every winner uses: the comment-to-DM lead magnet

The single most-repeated, highest-engagement play across the entire corpus is "comment [KEYWORD] + connect with me and I'll DM you [a real asset]." It is not a tactic, it is *the* growth engine of this niche:

Creator	Their keyword play	Comments it pulled
michel-lieben	"comment for the 14-page guide"	801 · 3,196
kenny-damian	"comment GTM / CLAUDE + connect"	890 – 2,214
sacha-martinot	"comment AGENT / GUIDE + connect"	740 – 1,493
nick-abraham	"comment EMAIL (must be connected)"	951 · 1,643
aidan-collins	"comment KIT / SOP + connect"	515 – 1,168
richard-illingworth	"comment KEYWORD + connect"	533 – 672
atishay-hyperke	"comment GEM / V2 + connect"	564 – 631
outboundphd	"comment [word] → DM the repo"	427 – 449
nikita-maildoso	"comment SMTP + connect"	302 – 724

Why it wins: comments are weighted heavily by the algorithm (velocity + volume), the "+ connect" clause converts a like into a *first-degree connection you can DM* (list-building), and the DM opens a warm sales channel. **Verdict for Taha:** **this mechanic goes on nearly every post.** It maps exactly to Bleed AI's existing "every post = a lead magnet" rule — we just haven't run it.

The second universal: own ONE contrarian wedge and hammer it

Every dominant creator owns a single heretical thesis and repeats it from a hundred angles:

- **richard-illingworth:** "it's not your copy, it's your *infrastructure*."
- **atishay-hyperke:** "stop obsessing over personalization — spend 80% of effort on the *list*; relevance > feeling good."
- **nikita-maildoso:** "'SMTP is trash' is a myth pushed by warm-up tools that profit from Google mailboxes."
- **michel-lieben:** "what you call an AI agent is just a clever workflow" + "outbound is a *data* problem, not a copy problem."
- **nick-abraham:** "fundamentals over tool-flexing — cold email isn't dead, you're just lazy."
- **josh-braun:** "handling objections is the problem; stop convincing, create conditions" (anti-pushiness).
- **outboundphd (Eric):** "throw the domain away, 2 emails beat 3+, kill generic AI personalization."

Taha's wedge (and it's backed by the consensus of the smartest operators here): "Volume outbound is dead — signal-based, systems-driven outbound wins." It fuses richard (infra) + atishay (relevance/list) + michel (data/signals) + nick (fundamentals). Defensible, differentiated, and true.

The two winning archetypes (Taha sits at their intersection)

- **Archetype A — the Systems/Tooling operator riding the AI/Claude-Code wave.** michel-lieben, kenny-damian, sacha-martinot, outboundphd, atishay. Highest ceilings *right now* come from "I built X with Claude Code / here's our whole stack / here's the agent that does an SDR's job." This is the current gold rush and the least crowded by the established media-company giants.
- **Archetype B — the Psychology/Worldview operator.** josh-braun (life parables → sales lessons) and charles-tenot (operator takes "average X vs great X"). Sells judgment and story; produces the biggest *emotional* virals and reach beyond the niche.

Taha's unfair position: he is *literally* an Archetype-A operator (building Bleed AI's AI-outbound engine in public with Claude Code + Clay + n8n) *and* he has real agency numbers to back it (like michel/nick/atishay). Almost nobody occupies both.

What WINS across everyone (do these)

1. **AI/build-in-public tooling content has the highest ceiling in 2026** (kenny 1,267; sachas 388/1,493c; outboundphd 342/427c; michel's Claude posts). Ride every Anthropic/Claude/tool release within days.
2. **Big-number authority hooks** — "20M emails," "\$7M ARR," "1,000,000 emails," "600+ hours in Claude Code." Concrete scale in line 1.
3. **Before/after + money-math** — michel "4,000 emails → 1 lead → \$4M ARR"; atishay "\$160K vs \$532K → extra \$372K."
4. **Confession / "I was completely wrong" hooks** — outboundphd's 252-like post; the highest-trust format in the corpus.
5. **Recycle your winners** — josh, michel, atishay, sachas all re-run their best posts months later with fresh numbers. Winners are re-runnable assets.
6. **Origin/vulnerability stories ~1x/week** for reach beyond the niche — nick's \$30k-debt story, atishay's "top 1%" story, nikita's Russia→Uruguay, josh's mother. These pull non-buyers and humanize the systems.

What FLOPS across everyone (avoid these)

1. **Pure deliverability/infra plumbing** underperforms for almost everyone (michel's lowest domain, nick's lowest big pillar, kenny, atishay). The boring tech loses to the flashy system reveal — *show the machine, don't teach the pipes*.
2. **Generic "value posts" / building-in-public with no lead magnet** (aidan: "value posts are dead; consistency without optimization = failure").
3. **Copywriting-craft-only posts** (kenny's weakest pillar, median 44).
4. **Pure promo/announcements without a metric or story wrapper** (sachas ColdIQ-promo flops at 15-28 likes; josh's announcements are his weakest).
5. **Naming unknown case-study logos** (outboundphd's data: unnamed "how we helped a company" beats "we helped [logo you've never heard of]").
6. **Vanity reply-rate screenshots** — nick, outboundphd, and atishay *all* mock them.

What they AVOID (structural discipline)

- **Hard-selling in the post body** — the pitch rides in a P.S. (michel) or waits for the DM. ~1 in 10 posts sells (Adam Robinson's rule, echoed everywhere).
- **Carousels on small accounts** — nearly everyone is text + single image/video despite occasionally preaching carousels.
- **Full automation of posting** — all keep a human in the loop (outboundphd, sachas explicitly).
- **Pricing/discount talk** in content.

🎯 The path Taha sticks on (ranked)

1. **PRIMARY model = kenny-damian × sachas-martinot × outboundphd (Eric)**. Build-in-public AI-outbound *systems*: post the real Claude Code skills, the Clay tables, the n8n workflows, the agents that do SDR work — each as a **comment-gated free asset**. This is the highest-ceiling, genuinely-Taha's, least-crowded lane. Ride every Claude/tool release first.
2. **LAYER michel-lieben's agency-transparency engine**: publish Bleed AI's whole machine + real funnel numbers, lead with a before/after money-math hook, quarantine the pitch in a P.S.

3. **SEASON with josh-braun / charles-tenot:** ~1 worldview/story post a week for reach beyond the niche + to plant the contrarian wedge as a *belief*, not a tip.
4. **RUN THE MECHANIC (from nick/richard/aidan/atishay):** comment-KEYWORD-+-connect lead magnet on nearly every post — it's the proven list-builder + reach-spike.
5. **OWN THE WEDGE:** "signal over volume, systems over copy" — the consensus of the smartest operators, and uniquely ownable given Bleed AI's real build.

Avoid: richard/nikita's pure-infra-plumbing *depth* (low median — reference it, don't lead with it), aidan's "kill all authority content" extremism (Taha needs credibility, not just giveaways), and being one more interchangeable "cold email tips" account.

THE FULL PER-CREATOR REPORTS

(11 LinkedIn creators + eric-nowoslawski by YouTube views. Ordered by strategic relevance to Taha.)

kenny-damian — Head of GTM at ColdIQ (now Frontal AI), the "Claude Code + n8n for outbound" operator-influencer

Kenny Damian is a GTM engineer who turned an internal agency role into a personal brand. Angle: he runs the actual outbound machine at a \$6-7M ARR agency (ColdIQ, 70+ clients, 23M+ cold emails sent) and posts the systems as free, ready-to-steal assets — n8n workflows, Claude Code skills, ICP/signal frameworks. He is the leading edge of the "AI-agents-do-the-outbound" wave: his breakout content is not cold-email tactics, it's *tooling* (Claude Code, n8n, Clay). He monetizes attention through comment-gated giveaways that feed his DMs and his agency pipeline.

Snapshot: 125 posts (Feb 2025 → Jul 2026) · likes median **78** / mean **122** / max **1,267** · domains: ai-automation-tooling **40%**, list-building-data 15%, agency-business 10%, channel-strategy 8%, copywriting 6%, deliverability 5% · formats: listicle (34), framework (32), teardown (26), engagement-bait (20), case-study (17), tactic (14). Heavy "announcement" wrapper (40 posts) because most content is a "here's what I built / giving away" launch.

Top 5 content pillars (ranked)

1. **AI automation & tooling (n8n + Claude Code)** — 50 posts, **40% share**, median **101** likes (highest-volume AND above-median). His whole engine. Contains every one of his top-4 posts. Sub-theme migration is visible: 2025 = "n8n workflows"; late-2025→2026 pivots hard to "Claude Code" (skills, MCP, hooks, agents).
2. **List-building & data** — 19 posts, **15%**, median 74. Scraping, enrichment, Clay workflows, buying-signal data sources (PredictLeads, Apollo, LeadMagic, Sales Nav).
3. **Agency business / systems** — 12 posts, **10%**, median 78. "\$0→\$6M ARR," 6-step systems, revenue-milestone case studies, positioning ("McKinsey for GTM").
4. **Channel strategy** — 10 posts, **8%**, median 82. Multichannel, outbound-vs-inbound, demand-creation-before-capture.
5. **Deliverability infrastructure** — 6 posts, **5%**, but the highest median of any pillar at **120**. Domain/inbox setup, warm-up, sending volume, metrics benchmarks. Small volume, reliably strong engagement.

(Copywriting is his weakest pillar — 8 posts, median just 44 — a notable gap for a "cold email" guy.)

Top 10 posts (by likes)

1. **1,267 likes (2,139 comments · 61 shares)** — personal+announcement / AI-agents teardown. **HOOK:** *"I set up 37 AI Agents for our \$6M ARR outbound agency. These are the 6 AI Agents we deploy across our >\$10M ARR clients."* Structure: pain-agitation intro ("I used to spend HOURS..."), then a numbered "meet the team" list of 6 named agents (COMPANY_ANALYST, PAIN_EXPERT, SIGNAL_HUNTER, SEGMENT_STRATEGIST, TRIGGER_SPECIALIST, CAMPAIGN_BUILDER), each with bulleted outputs. Soft CTA: "I'll be putting together an entire SOP... let me know if you want it." Tone: confident operator, generous, systems-obsessed. The 2,139:61 comment-to-share ratio is the giveaway mechanic firing.
2. **1,033 likes (88 comments · 95 shares)** — personal cheat-sheet. **HOOK:** *"I've spent 600+ hours inside Claude Code. Here's the complete cheat sheet I wish I had before starting. Saving this will save you dozens of hours of trial and error."* 8 numbered sections (Install, CLAUDE.md, slash commands, Skills, MCP, Hooks, keyboard, CLI flags). Note the *inverted* ratio — 95 shares > 88 comments: pure reference value made people save/share instead of comment. Best hook formula he has: authority number ("600+ hours") + "the cheat sheet I wish I had."
3. **871 likes (2,214 comments · 17 shares)** — framework. **HOOK:** *"Claude Code can now prospect, enrich, write copy, and launch campaigns. Here is the full breakdown."* 7-step end-to-end pipeline (detect signals → score vs ICP → find

DMS via Sales Nav → enrich across 3 providers → generate copy → push to campaign → analyze). Line: "The project folder becomes your GTM brain." CTA to an HD guide link + comment. 2,214 comments = peak lead-gen bait.

4. **802 likes (2,175 comments · 36 shares)** — announcement/tactic. **HOOK:** "*Claude can now build 90% of enterprise-level n8n workflows for you. You just prompt in plain english.*" Describes a Claude project setup (system prompt + 50pg n8n docs + prompt templates). **CTA:** comment "CLAUDE" and make sure we're connected so I can DM it. Explicit comment-gate.
5. **405 likes (1,616 comments · 8 shares)** — teardown. **HOOK:** "*I just open-sourced the 15 Claude Code skills we now run across 70+ clients at our \$7M ARR GTM agency.*" 5 pillars / 15 skills / "~4,200 lines of operational methodology," closes on a "flywheel" metaphor. **CTA:** comment "GTM" for the repo.
6. **380 likes (890 comments · 9 shares)** — announcement. **HOOK:** "*Giving away this n8n Pre-Sales Call Research Workflow.*" Short (592 chars) checkmark list of what it does. CTA: comment "sales" + connect. His earliest proven giveaway template.
7. **285 likes** — announcement. **HOOK:** "*I'm happy to share that I'm starting a new position as Head of GTM at ColdIQ!*" One line. LinkedIn's native "new position" template — pure social-proof engagement, zero effort.
8. **208 likes** — announcement/personal. **HOOK:** "*Yesterday, 1,400+ people watched Ivan Falco and I build an entire Outbound campaign live using Claude Code.*" Recap of a live build (scored 110 companies in a minute, Apollo API, waterfall enrichment, loaded to Instantly). CTA: comment "Webinar" for recording + repos.
9. **195 likes** — framework/case-study. **HOOK:** "*We sent 1,000,000+ cold emails so you don't have to. Here is the 6-step system we deploy across 70+ clients.*" Lead sourcing → strategy → copywriting → Clay → evergreen → tech stack (\$1,500-3,000/mo), ending "This system took us from \$0 to \$6M ARR." Names real tools throughout.
10. **193 likes** — case-study. **HOOK:** "*This n8n workflow saves our sales team 10 hours+ a week. 10 hours X 8 reps = 80 hrs. That's at least \$10,000 saved monthly.*" ROI-first hook, then the exact node chain (Cal.com → Clay → Relevance AI → Perplexity → OpenAI → HTML report), punchline "cost per report is \$0.47 in API calls." CTA: comment "Sales."

Pattern: 8 of 10 are AI-tooling; **every giveaway post carries a comment-gate CTA**, and the ones that do pull 890-2,214 comments — 10-25x his median like count.

Top 5 contrarian takes

1. **"Most teams spend \$50k on SDRs before spending \$5000 on demand."** (posted twice: 136 + 71 likes) — you're trying to capture demand that doesn't exist yet; build Foundation → Demand Creation → Demand Capture in order. Outbound converts 3x better "when prospects already know your name." A demand-gen argument aimed at outbound people.
2. **"Buying signals won't grow your pipeline. Prioritized signals will."** (76) — teams chase every blip (a like, a web visit) and stay at 1-2% reply. Tier signals 1-4; "the error is treating a Tier 4 signal like a Tier 1 trigger." Tier 1 (funding/expansion/leadership change) = same-day outbound; Tier 4 (social activity) = "context, not a trigger."
3. **"Most teams think AI agents jump straight to full automation... The trust is earned in tiny steps."** (44) — a 5-gate "ladder of trust"; every action needs human approval early. Anti-hype counterweight to his own agent content.
4. **"'Hope you are doing well' → delete. 'Saw you are hiring 3 AEs after your Series B' → reply."** — from the 9-step post. Plus **"500 laser-targeted > 100,000 spray and pray"** and **"Stop asking for meetings first line — you earn calls by giving value."**
5. **"Ignore open rates and CTR. They are unreliable and can hurt deliverability."** (GTM cheatsheet) — track reply rate and Positive Reply Rate instead; **"Lead with the trigger, not with your name and title."**

End-to-end strategy

- **Cadence:** high and consistent — ~125 posts across 17 months (roughly 7-8/month, near-daily in active stretches).
- **Format mix:** a repeatable wrapper — announcement ("*I built / giving away X*") → numbered listicle or framework (5-9 steps, arrow bullets, emoji-numbered headers) → visual cheat-sheet image → comment-gated CTA. Almost every post is a launch of an asset.
- **Hooks:** three proven molds — (a) **big authority number** ("37 AI agents," "600+ hours," "1,000,000+ cold emails," "23M+ emails," "\$6M ARR"); (b) **"X can now do Y"** capability announcements (Claude Code / Claude n8n); (c) **"we did the work so you don't have to."** He leans on ColdIQ's scale as borrowed credibility in nearly every hook.

- **CTA / lead-magnet mechanics:** the core engine is **comment-to-DM gating** — "Comment 'GTM'/'CLAUDE'/'Sales' and make sure we're connected so I can DM it." This (1) spikes the comment signal (2,000+ on top posts) which the algorithm rewards, (2) forces a connection request (list-building), and (3) opens a DM thread = warm outbound channel into his own agency funnel. Secondary CTA: external HD-guide links (lnkd.in) and "comment 'Webinar' for the recording."
- **Funnel/monetization:** free workflow/skill → comment → connect → DM the asset → asset showcases ColdIQ/Frontal's methodology → some fraction become agency leads ("Elite Clay Studio Partner," "McKinsey for GTM"). The personal brand is the top of ColdIQ/Frontal's funnel; the rebrand-to-Frontal post confirms he's the face of the agency's positioning.
- **Engagement tactics:** giveaways (bait), ending on a question ("What's the ONE metric you focus on?", "Any other signals?"), naming real tools/people (Ivan Falco, Michel Lieben) for network reach, and "save this" framing on reference posts.

Differentiation & verdict

- **Differentiator:** He's a *builder-influencer* — not cold-email theory but shippable infrastructure (importable n8n JSON, open-sourced Claude Code skill repos). He owns the "Claude Code for GTM / AI agents run outbound" narrative earlier and harder than anyone in this corpus, and backs it with real agency scale (70+ clients, 23M emails, \$6M→\$7M ARR).
- **What WORKS (evidence):** AI-tooling content is 40% of output but carries all 4 of his 800+ like posts and holds an above-median 101. Comment-gating produces 890-2,214 comments — 10-25x his median. Authority-number hooks + "cheat sheet" framing produced his two biggest posts (1,267 and 1,033). Deliverability posts punch above weight (median 120 on 6 posts). Riding a *platform* wave (Claude Code launch cycle, late-25/early-26) timed his growth.
- **What HASN'T (evidence):** Pure copywriting is his weakest pillar (median 44 vs 78 overall) — the actual craft of the email underperforms the tooling around it. Contrarian/opinion posts (demand-gen, signal-tiering) top out at 76-136, far below his tooling launches — his audience wants assets, not arguments. Low-effort personal announcements (new job = 285) spike once but don't compound.
- **What they AVOID:** No pricing/discount talk, no client-shaming teardowns, minimal personal-life/mindset content (only 2 mindset posts), no political/industry-drama. He avoids selling the agency directly in-post — the pitch is always implicit via the free asset.

Steal for Taha (cold-email / outbound, build-in-public)

1. **Comment-gate every lead magnet.** Taha's "every post = a lead magnet" system should route through "*comment 'X' + connect so I can DM it,*" not a link. Kenny's data is unambiguous: this converts a 78-like post into 2,000+ comments and manufactures both an algorithmic spike and a warm DM list. It's the single highest-leverage mechanic in the corpus.
2. **Lead hooks with borrowed-scale authority numbers.** "We sent 1,000,000 cold emails / 23M emails / built 500 workflows so you don't have to." Bleed AI has real send volume and reply-rate data — package it as "we ran X campaigns, here's the 6-step system," and end on the ARR/result. Concrete number in line 1, result in the last line.
3. **Ship the system as an asset, not advice.** Kenny gives away importable n8n JSON and open-source skill repos; the asset is the ad for the agency. Taha can publish a real Clay table / Instantly sequence / signal-tiering sheet as the giveaway — build-in-public where the free thing demonstrates the paid competence.
4. **Ride the tooling wave, sell the human.** His winning meta-narrative is "the tools are commoditized — companies buy the stack but can't run it; you need people who know how" (the Frontal thesis). That's a ready-made cold-outbound and content angle for Bleed AI: don't sell "AI outbound," sell "we're the operators who make your AI outbound actually book meetings."

sacha-martinot — ColdIQ growth builder turned "Claude Code for GTM" evangelist

Sacha Martinot is a GTM/automation builder at **ColdIQ** (a ~\$7M-ARR cold-outbound agency) who has turned himself into the go-to LinkedIn face for **"build your own AI agent / skill / workflow with Claude Code."** His angle: he is explicitly *not a developer* ("I built 13 B2B tools in 1 month, I'm not a developer") and packages ColdIQ's internal GTM machinery — Clay waterfalls, n8n workflows, Claude Code skills — into free lead magnets. Nearly every post is a build-in-public showcase that ends in a comment-to-DM CTA. He rides the Claude Code / Anthropic product-launch news cycle harder than anyone in the corpus.

Snapshot: 38 posts · **median 47** / mean 79 / max 388 likes · min 15. Domains: **ai-automation-tooling 82%** (31/38), promo-announcement 3, linkedin-content 2, mindset 1, industry-commentary 1. Formats: announcement (19), teardown (14), personal (11), story (6), listicle (6), engagement-bait (5), contrarian-take (4). Tool name-drops dominated by **Claude Code (34/38)**, then n8n (10), Clay (10), FullEnrich (8), ColdIQ (7), Instantly (7), Prospeo (5), MCP (4). **The real signal is comments, not likes** — his two biggest posts drew 1,493 and 1,101 comments on 388/387 likes (comment-to-DM lead-magnet mechanic).

Top 5 content pillars (ranked)

1. **AI-agent build showcases ("I just built an agent that ___")** — ~37% share (14 posts), median ~53 likes, but owns both peaks (388, 274). Flagship format: build a Claude Code / Managed Agent that does a GTM task (scrapes skills, writes landing pages, tests tools, finds phone numbers) → 5-step teardown → comment for the guide.
2. **n8n / cold-outbound GTM workflows** — ~24% (9 posts), median 44, max 125. Clay waterfalls, enrichment, reply managers, "13 n8n workflows we built," Clay-credit optimization, "6 APIs the top 1% of sales teams run on."
3. **Claude Code Skills packs** — small n but **highest-quality engagement** (109, 93, 90, 164, 27). "7 skills / 67 sub-skills from our \$7M ARR agency," ColdIQ Skills Directory, the skill-finder tool, "how Anthropic engineers actually use Claude Code."
4. **LinkedIn content system (meta / build-in-public)** — only 3 posts but **highest median (101), incl. a 387-like hit**. "I built my own LinkedIn Content Hub with Claude Code" — posts about the machine that makes his posts, proof-stacked with his own follower/impression numbers.
5. **Tool teardowns & contrarian AI-industry takes** — Ruflo, Pixel Agents, vidIQ MCP, "Dynamic Workflows came for n8n," Lovable MCP, WorkOS "your best customer is an AI agent." Plus a rare personal/mindset lane (Tokyo salarymen, 80 likes) that outperforms his median.

Top 10 posts (by likes)

1. **388 (+1,493c / 8s) · announcement+teardown** · Anthropic Managed Agents + Claude Code. **HOOK:** "You can now create a 24/7 working AI agent in 30 seconds." Structure: bold claim → "Anthropic just dropped X" → "the ultimate builder stack" (2 arrows) → numbered 1–4 how-it-works → "Real example (watch the video below)" GTM agent (Clay→email→Instantly) → **Comment "AGENT" for my Notion doc**. Voice: breathless, present-tense, "you can close your laptop, they keep working."
2. **387 (+1,101c / 4s) · story** · LinkedIn Content Hub. **HOOK:** "I built my own LinkedIn Content Hub with Claude Code. 2 posts in, both went viral." Structure: challenge setup ("post 5x/week for 3 months") → proof (Post 1: 97 likes/300 comments, Post 2: 250/1,150; "1k followers in 5 days") → app feature bullets → **the "real secret" pivot** ("isn't the app — it's the 7 Claude Code skills") → **like + comment "GUIDE."** Voice: humble-brag, receipts-first.
3. **274 (+740c / 5s) · personal+teardown** · agent that scrapes Claude Code skills. **HOOK:** "I just built an AI Agent that scrapes the best Claude Code Skills on autopilot, 24/7." Structure: pain ("used to take me 5 hours a week... now 3 minutes") → 5 labeled steps (Scraping/Focus/Dedup/Approval/Publishing) → **challenge close** ("what's keeping you from building one?") → comment "SCRAPER." Ties to owned asset coldiq.com/skills.
4. **164 (+35c / 14s) · teardown+personal** · how Anthropic engineers use Claude Code. **HOOK:** "Here's how Anthropic engineers actually use Claude Code. I just watched their talk... and it changed how I think about AI agents." Structure: "300-IQ math genius with no expertise" reframe → **4 numbered rules** (Prompt Skills not Claude; build tools not instructions; MCP≠Skills; Skills compound) → "I saved you the 8 hours... it's right below." Note: fewest comments but most shares (14) — pure-value post, no gate.

5. **125 (+373c / 1s) • announcement+listicle** • 13 n8n workflows. **HOOK:** "Here are 13 n8n workflows we built with Claude Code ↓ And I'm giving them all away for free." Structure: "breakdown of 6 of them" → numbered workflows with node-count + difficulty ("GTM Flywheel — 81 nodes, hard") → "...and 7 more in the full doc" → **comment "N8N."** The node counts are the credibility flex.
6. **109 (+346c / 2s) • announcement** • 7 skills from \$7M ARR agency. **HOOK:** "7 Claude Code skills from our \$7M ARR agency. And I'm giving them away for free ↓" Structure: What we did (7 master / 67 sub-skills) → How it works (orchestrator routes: "Write me a cold email for a VP of Sales" → loads framework) → the 7 skills w/ sub-counts → comment "SKILLS" → **question close** ("Which one are you installing first?").
7. **103 • announcement+contrarian** • Dynamic Workflows. **HOOK:** "Claude Code just shipped Dynamic Workflows. And I think they just came for n8n." Structure: before/after ("meant building it in n8n by hand... now I just type 'workflow'") → capability arrows → **balanced "but n8n isn't dead"** → "My new rule" decision framework → **open-question CTA** ("Still team n8n?"). No lead magnet — pure engagement play.
8. **101 • story** • Content Hub v2 (rerun of #2). **HOOK:** "I built my own Content Hub with Claude Code... and it completely changed the way I view content now." Same skeleton as #2 with fresher proof (3,000+ followers, 400k+ impressions, 5,000+ comments "1 month in") → comment "CONTENT." Shows he **recycles his best-performing template with updated numbers.**
9. **93 • announcement+personal** • viral-post skills. **HOOK:** "3 of my last 4 posts went viral, here's the Claude Code skills that I used to write them." Structure: authority ("20+ people posting, 13 above 5,000 followers") → 7 skills, each with a **data nugget** ("First 210 chars = 80% of performance," "Carousels 2.5–3.5x reach," "Comments > 15 words = 4x weight, Saves = 5x," "Tue–Thu 7:30–8:30 AM") → comment "LINKEDIN." Densest data-per-line post.
10. **90 • announcement+engagement-bait** • free skill-finder tool. **HOOK:** "I just built a free tool that finds you the perfect Claude Code Skill in 10 seconds." Structure: directory's problem ("you still have to dig through it") → "So I flipped it" → 3 steps (Describe/Rank/Install) → "free, never goes stale" → comment "SKILL." Productizes his own earlier scraper.

Top 5 contrarian takes

1. **"Claude Code just shipped Dynamic Workflows. And I think they just came for n8n."** — but nuanced: n8n still owns always-on triggers and non-technical readability; Claude Code wins when it "needs to think, branch, fan out, or live in my code."
2. **"Everyone on LinkedIn claims you can build any n8n workflow with Claude Code now. But without the right skills loaded, it'll ship workflows that break in production."** — the error-path argument: "almost everyone gets the happy path right but few think of the error path" (retry logic, error workflow, dead-letter queue). A jab at the hype crowd he's part of.
3. **"Soon, your best customer won't be human, it'll be an AI agent."** — "The old rule was 'make something people want.' The new one: make something agents want. If an AI agent can't use your product, you're invisible to the fastest-growing buyers on earth" (riffing on WorkOS's auth.md).
4. **"This Claude Code extension looks completely useless... I installed it as a joke. Then I started working with 5 agents in parallel. And suddenly it became the most useful thing on my screen."** — the fake-dismissal reversal hook (Pixel Agents).
5. **"Prompt Skills, not Claude... Most people are still writing prompts when the real leverage is in building."** — reframes the entire prompt-engineering discourse as obsolete vs. packaging reusable Skills/tools.

End-to-end strategy

- **Cadence:** Self-declared 5x/week (Mon–Fri) challenge; corpus shows a heavy Apr–Jun ramp (near-daily some weeks). Roughly one flagship "I built ___" per week plus filler teardowns/news-jacks.
- **Format mix:** ~90% is a single repeatable spine — **hook** → **context/pain** → **numbered 3-to-7-step teardown (with emoji or arrow bullets)** → **proof metric** → **gated CTA**. Occasional pure-value (no-gate) and personal posts to reset the "salesy" ratio.
- **Hooks:** Round-number specificity ("13 tools," "7 skills," "24/7 in 30 seconds," "in 10 seconds"), authority anchoring ("from our \$7M ARR agency," "Anthropic engineers"), fake-dismissal reversal ("looks completely useless"), and news-

jack ("X just shipped ___, and I think ___"). He explicitly preaches "first 210 characters = 80% of performance" and eats his own cooking.

- **CTA / lead-magnet mechanics:** The core engine is "**comment [KEYWORD] + make sure we're connected + like → I'll DM you my Notion doc/guide/repo.**" Keywords: AGENT, GUIDE, SCRAPER, N8N, SKILLS, LINKEDIN, CONTENT, SKILL, PIXEL, LINK. This is why comments dwarf likes (1,493 comments on 388 likes) — the metric he's actually farming is the DM connection + follow, not vanity likes.
- **Funnel / monetization:** Free doc/skill → new follower + connection → warm audience for **ColdIQ** (agency + Skills Directory at coldiq.com/skills + free tools). Every lead magnet routes back to a ColdIQ-owned asset. He's building ColdIQ's inbound top-of-funnel using himself as the creator.
- **Engagement tactics:** Keyword-comment gate (algorithmic comment velocity), "make sure we're connected" (forces the follow before the payoff), open-loop questions ("Which one are you installing first?", "Still team n8n?"), "watch the video below" (dwell time), and recycling proven templates with refreshed numbers.

Differentiation & verdict

- **Differentiator:** He's the corpus's purest "**agency IP → free Claude Code lead magnet**" operator. Others teach cold-email theory; Sacha ships a downloadable *machine* every post and news-jacks every Anthropic/Claude release within days. The "I'm not a developer but I built this" positioning makes it feel replicable to a non-technical GTM audience.
- **What WORKS (evidence):** (1) Comment-gated lead magnets — 1,493 / 1,101 / 740 comments on the top three; comments run 3–4x likes across all gated posts. (2) The numbered-teardown-of-a-thing-I-built template — his 4 highest posts all use it. (3) Meta content-about-content — the "Content Hub" story hit 387 likes/1,101 comments and was successful enough to **rerun a month later** (101 likes) with new proof. (4) Proof-stacking with specific numbers ("81 nodes," "1k followers in 5 days," "\$0.40/image, \$1/hero video") reads as credibility, not fluff. (5) One clean pure-value post (Anthropic engineers, 164 likes, 14 shares) earned the most shares — ungated value travels further.
- **What HASN'T (evidence):** Straight ColdIQ promo without a personal build angle underperforms badly — "we've managed \$25M in LinkedIn ads" (15 likes), "ColdIQ just hit \$7M ARR" (28), "most Clay accounts waste half their credits" (16). Deep-in-the-weeds tactical listicles ("6 APIs the top 1% run on," 21; "if you're using Claude Code without these 5 skills," 27) also lag — the audience wants the *shiny built thing*, not the parts list.
- **What he AVOIDS:** Carousels (despite preaching they get "2.5–3.5x more reach," his corpus is text+single-image/video — a notable gap between his advice and practice). No hard pitches, no pricing, no client case-study selling. Minimal opinion/political content. He avoids being ungated *most* of the time — value is almost always behind a comment.

Steal for Taha (cold-email / outbound, build-in-public)

1. **Package Bleed AI's internal machinery as free, comment-gated lead magnets.** Sacha's #1 engine is "here's the actual Clay waterfall / n8n reply-manager / skills pack we run — comment KEYWORD and I'll DM it." Taha has the equivalent (campaign-master recipes, the LM sales agent, follow-up GIF system). One real, downloadable artifact per post → farm the DM connection, not the like. Note the 3–4x comment-to-like multiplier this produces.
2. **News-jack every Anthropic/Claude/tool release with a "here's how I'd wire it into outbound" teardown.** His "Managed Agents in 30 seconds" (388) and "Dynamic Workflows came for n8n" (103) prove first-mover on a launch, framed through *your* use case (a GTM agent: Clay → cold email → Instantly), beats generic thought-leadership. Taha can own the "Claude Code for cold outbound" beat.
3. **Prove it with granular numbers, not adjectives.** "81 nodes," "\$0.40/image," "1k followers in 5 days," "First 210 chars = 80% of performance." Specific counts read as a practitioner; round vague claims read as marketing. Every Bleed AI post should carry one hard, checkable metric (reply rate, cost-per-lead, workflow node count).
4. **Build-in-public the content system itself, and rerun your winners.** The "I built my own Content Hub" meta-post was his single best non-launch hit and he reran it with fresh numbers a month later. Taha showing *the machine that makes Bleed AI's outbound* (with updated reply-rate proof each time) is a repeatable, high-median template — and don't gate every post: his one ungated value post earned the most shares.

outboundphd – Eric Nowoslawski, the technical-outbound "engineer" of cold email

Founder of **Growth Engine X (GEX)**, a **Clay Enterprise Partner**. His angle is the opposite of the deliverability-guru crowd: he treats cold email as an **engineering + data problem**, not a copywriting one. He publicly reverse-engineers the Clay/AI/code stack in real time, gives away massive free assets (119-page doc, 29-skill repo), and positions himself as the guy operating one release cycle ahead of the market ("outbound 4.0"). Build-in-public technologist who monetizes credibility, not courses.

Snapshot: 349 tagged posts (Jan 2025 – Jul 2026) · **median 84 / mean 94 / max 342** likes · ~18–20 posts/month, near-daily, remarkably steady (dipped only Sep '25 = 11, Dec '25 = 13). Domains: **ai-automation-tooling 25% · list-building-data 24% · deliverability-infra 10% · promo 10% · industry-commentary 7% · copywriting 6%**. Formats: teardown (90), contrarian-take (80), personal (75), announcement (67), case-study (55), framework (51). Tool obsession is the tell: **Clay mentioned 152x**, Claygent 48x, Smartlead 29x, Supabase 27x, Claude Code 25x, Cursor 23x, Prospeo 21x, Codex 19x, Apify 17x.

Top 5 content pillars (ranked)

1. **AI & automation tooling** — 88 posts · **25%** share · **median 95 likes** (his highest-median major pillar). Claude Code/Codex/Skills, prompt-caching, agentic Clay-table building. This is where his ceiling is (342, 297, 252, 223, 217 all live here).
2. **List-building & data** — 85 posts · **24%** · median 82. Enrichment waterfalls, Clay Derived Datapoints, Supabase caching, data-source teardowns, verification.
3. **Deliverability & infra** — 35 posts · **10%** · median 83. Domains, inbox warmup, sending platforms — but notably he *deflates* this topic rather than mystifies it.
4. **Promo / announcements** — 34 posts · **10%** · median 84. Clay-ecosystem news, cheatsheets, his own free drops. Highest raw reach lives here (307, 269, 212).
5. **Industry commentary** — 26 posts · **7%** · median **89** (2nd-highest median). "Is outbound dead," hot-takes on the space, calling out bad practices. Small but punchy. (*Note: agency-business at 16 posts has the highest median of all, 107 — his rare business/pricing takes overperform.*)

Top 10 posts (by likes)

1. **342L (+427c / 7s)** · announcement/give-away · *29 Claude skills repo for auto-launching self-improving cold email*. HOOK: **"I put 29 Claude skills into this repository so anyone can launch a cold email campaign automatically that ALSO self improves. Here's how you can get it for free."** Structure: hook → credibility flex ("2M lines of code, daily in Claude Code since January") → numbered 1–5 overview of the repo → surprise "30th skill" → comment-to-DM CTA ("comment your favorite restaurant"). Tone: generous flex, insider, slightly braggy but earns it with specifics. **Note the 427 comments — the free-repo + comment-gate combo is his single most powerful engagement engine.**
2. **307L (+88c / 12s)** · announcement/give-away · *free 119-page cold email doc*. HOOK: **"I spent every day over the Christmas break putting my thoughts on Cold Email into 119 pages of content. Here's the link if anyone would like to read it."** Structure: effort-signal → altruism framing ("I give this away free to help people getting started") → explicit share-ask → raw Inkd.in link. Tone: humble-generous. Highest shares (12) — a genuine value bomb.
3. **297L (+449c / 4s)** · personal/teardown · *Claude Skills as knowledge-work replacement*. HOOK: **"I don't see enough people in marketing talking about Claude Skills and I think it's wildly impactful for knowledge work. I'll give you one of my favorites in this post."** Structure: contrarian gap ("nobody's talking about this") → plain-English definition → personal struggle ("For months I tried to build an email copywriting bot... frustrating as hell") → what it does now (bulleted signal-ranking) → "comment 'skills'" CTA + open question. **449 comments — his highest.**
4. **288L (+45c / 4s)** · announcement · *Clay Derived Datapoints*. HOOK: **"Clay silently released some of my favorite data points to help you zero in on your ICP and I don't see anyone talking about."** Structure: scoop framing → where to find it → question-format feature list (B2B/B2C? subindustry? revenue streams?) → enthusiasm close ("Love Competitor Strategy Teardown — Bleed AI it Clay team!"). Tone: insider-first-to-know.

5. **269L (+29c / 3s)** · announcement/personal · *Clay's unicorn raise + his exit story*. HOOK: **"My decision to leave Clay was calculated but man I'm bad at math... all jokes aside, congrats."** Self-deprecating pun → congratulate ecosystem → name-drop leaders to connect with. Pure ecosystem-affiliation play.
6. **252L (+53c / 9s)** · contrarian/high-signal · *prompt caching to cut token cost*. HOOK: **"I've been completely wrong about AI prompting, and it's cost me thousands of dollars and it might be costing you money too."** Structure: confession hook → "here's what I told you before" (the wrong way, numbered) → the reveal (OpenAI enterprise rep call) → the fix ("put everything that changes at the very bottom of your prompt") → hard numbers (50% GPT-4o-mini, 90% GPT-4 savings) → **public apology** ("I'm sorry I made the wrong suggestion for so long"). His best-structured teaching post.
7. **238L (+36c / 2s)** · contrarian/one-liner · HOOK **(the entire post, 53 chars): "Founders and their dumb domain purchases, am I right?"** Pure engagement-bait shitpost — proves his audience rewards insider in-jokes with zero effort.
8. **223L (+85c / 9s)** · case-study · *Claude Code doubled reply rates in a week*. HOOK: **"Claude Code doubled response rates in one week for an enterprise client of ours. We're starting to run Autoresearch for our customers. This is what it means."** Structure: result-first hook → borrowed authority (Karpathy's Autoresearch repo) → "I immediately thought..." → the mechanism (pick one metric = Positive Response Rate, numbered 1-3 pipeline) → lessons learned → "we'll give the repo away" → comment CTA + teammate credits. Coins **"outbound 4.0."**
9. **217L (+33c / 0s)** · story · *how he recruited Arturo to Clay*. HOOK: **"This is the legend of how Arturo Orozco joined the Clay team..."** Pure relationship/status story, zero tactics — shows his network *is* the content.
10. **217L (+61c / 4s)** · story/demo · *Codex/goal auto-builds Clay tables*. HOOK: **"I used Codex's new /goal command to automatically generate Clay tables. Here it is live building a table."** Live-demo framing → "rushed to get my tripod" authenticity → what he asked it to do (500k rows → Supabase → waterfall) → soft recruiting CTA ("could use great Codex/Claude Code people").

Top 5 contrarian takes

1. **"I've been completely wrong about AI prompting... it's cost me thousands"** (252L) — reverses his own advice; move variable data to the *bottom* of the prompt so it caches (50–90% token savings). Self-correction as authority.
2. **"Controversial opinion: Every agency should be using Supabase to cache data"** (208L) — stop repurchasing leads; cache every email found (23M+ cached), requery instead of rebuy. "But I'm not technical" → "You don't need to be. Cursor will set up your schema."
3. **"The tests are in and we are NOT allowing generic AI personalizations as first lines anymore"** (140L) — kills the tactic he used to preach. "Sophisticated buyers recognize generic AI personalization instantly." Fix: lead with a real signal, or **"treat cold email like a banner ad — put the offer in the preview text, make it punchy, no fake personalization."**
4. **"Most of our inbound leads come from YouTube, not LinkedIn"** (161L) — admits the platform he spends 10x more time on (LinkedIn) loses to YouTube on attribution. Rare public honesty about his own channel ROI.
5. **"I haven't logged into Make in 4 months"** (153L) / **"Don't pay for email deliverability consulting"** (132L) — twin anti-tool/anti-guru takes: move automations from Make/n8n to code (Cursor/Claude Code/Trigger.dev), and deliverability is just a repeatable checklist, not a service worth hiring for. He commoditizes the things others sell.

End-to-end strategy

- **Cadence:** near-daily, ~18–20/month, sustained 18 months. Consistency over virality — median 84 with occasional 250–340 spikes.
- **Format mix:** teardown + contrarian-take + personal story are the backbone (~70% of posts). He alternates *dense tactical teardown* → *short hot-take/shitpost* → *personal/relationship story*. The one-liner shitposts ("Founders and their dumb domain purchases") keep the feed presence up between heavy posts.
- **Hooks:** three repeatable molds — (a) **"I've been wrong / I was completely wrong about X"** confession hooks (highest-trust), (b) **"[Tool] silently/just released X and nobody's talking about it"** scoop hooks, (c) **result-first** ("Claude Code doubled response rates in one week"). Almost always first-person, specific, and slightly ahead of the

- **CTA / lead-magnet mechanics:** the signature move is **comment-gated give-aways** — "comment 'skills' and I'll send you the file," "comment your favorite restaurant and I'll send the repo." This is why his top posts have **400+ comments**: the asset is real and valuable (repo, 119-page doc, campaign-strategy file), the comment ask is low-friction/fun, and delivery is via DM. Give-away posts are his single biggest reach + list-building lever. ~26 posts explicitly promise to "send" something.
- **Funnel / monetization:** LinkedIn = top-of-funnel credibility for **GEX (done-for-you outbound agency)** + his **Clay Enterprise Partner** status. He rarely hard-sells. The funnel is: free asset → DM relationship → agency/enterprise conversion. He openly says inbound actually converts better on **YouTube**, so LinkedIn is brand/authority, not the closing channel. Repeated "we'll open-source it when ready" also functions as recruiting bait for engineers.
- **Engagement tactics:** comment-gates, open questions ("What knowledge work are you still doing manually?"), teammate/peer name-drops (Gabe Emerson, Jeff Barg, Arturo, Matthew Lucero — tags = reach + relationship signaling), and low-effort insider shitposts to stay top-of-feed.

Differentiation & verdict

- **Differentiator:** he's the **engineer among marketers**. While the niche argues copy and deliverability, he's shipping Claude Code repos, Supabase caches, and Codex-built Clay tables. He's *first* to every new tool and frames himself as living in the future ("outbound 4.0," "the next phase of outbound"). His moat is being technical + Clay-insider + genuinely generous.
- **What WORKS (evidence):** (1) **Free high-value assets + comment-gate** — the 29-skill repo (342L/427c) and 119-page doc (307L/12 shares) are his ceiling. (2) **Confession/self-correction hooks** — "I've been completely wrong" (252L) with a hard number and an apology. (3) **Scoop posts on Clay** — his insider access ("Clay silently released..." 288L) is content nobody else can make. (4) AI-automation pillar carries the highest median (95) of any major pillar. (5) Even 53-character shitposts hit 238L — his audience trusts the name.
- **What HASN'T (evidence):** offers/lead-magnets pillar underperforms (median **63**, his lowest) and linkedin-content meta-posts median **52** — talking *about* content/offers flops; showing *tools* wins. Pure listicles/tactics without a personal or contrarian frame sit at median 71–77, below his 84 baseline. Long generic "how-to" without a scoop or confession angle is average at best.
- **What they AVOID:** hype/hard-selling his own agency, pricing debates, motivational/mindset fluff (mindset-career median 75, and he posts little of it), fake reply-rate screenshots (he actively mocks them: "*Ignore LinkedIn screenshots bragging about reply rates*"), and deliverability fear-mongering (he deflates it as a checklist). No courses, no "DM me to scale your agency" spam.

Steal for Taha (cold-email / outbound, build-in-public)

1. **Ship a comment-gated free asset, for real.** His two biggest posts (342L, 307L) were both "here's a genuinely valuable thing, comment X and I'll send it." Taha has the campaign-master skills library, recipes, and internal SOPs — package one (e.g. a "signal-based cold email starter kit" or a Clay/Instantly workflow) and run the exact **"comment 'X' → DM the asset"** mechanic. It builds the list *and* prints 100s of comments.
2. **Confession hooks + a hard number + a public correction.** "I was completely wrong about [thing I used to preach], here's the fix, here's the % it saved, sorry" (252L). It's the highest-trust format in the corpus and Taha has real reversals to mine (volume-is-dead → signal-based = 5x reply). Lead with the mistake, not the win.
3. **Be the one who publicly reverse-engineers the new tool first.** Eric owns "outbound 4.0 / Claude Code for cold email" by simply being first and specific. Taha can own **"signal-based outbound with [Clay + Apollo/Prospeo + Instantly]"** the same way — teardown posts naming exact tools, exact costs (Eric brags ".02 per email with 40-mini"), exact metrics.
4. **Alternate register: heavy teardown → short insider hot-take → relationship story.** Don't make every post a masterclass. His 53-char shitpost hit 238L. Mixing low-effort in-group jokes and peer name-drops between the dense posts keeps feed presence high without burning out.

micHEL-lieben — founder of ColdIQ (a ~\$7M-ARR AI-powered outbound agency); angle: "operator flexing the machine"

His angle is "operator flexing the machine" — publishing his own agency's tool stacks, funnels, and Claude-Code GTM automations as the proof that sells the service.

Snapshot: 332 posts analyzed · median 273 likes · mean 322 · max 2,794 · min 26. Primary domains: agency-business (79), ai-automation-tooling (67), linkedin-content (48), channel-strategy (37), list-building-data (27). Typical formats: listicle (147), announcement (89), personal (70), engagement-bait (65), case-study (64), teardown (50). Cadence is metronomic — ~20-23 posts/month for all of 2025, tapering to ~12-16/month in 2026 (near-daily, one channel, one voice). Top recurring tools name-dropped: Clay (164), Instantly.ai (141), lemlist (125), FullEnrich (83), Prospeo (80), Claude Code (47).

Top 5 content pillars (ranked 1-5)

1. **"Every tool / funnel behind our \$XM agency" — stack & funnel teardowns.** The engine of the account. Covers his own ColdIQ stack ("We just crossed \$400K MRR, here's every tool"), full-funnel breakdowns ("What our \$4.8M/year funnel looks like"), and reverse-engineered competitor stacks (lemlist's \$34M ARR). ~79 posts (agency-business), median 308 likes / mean 410 — his highest-performing domain by both volume and reach. Four of his top 8 posts live here.
2. **AI/Claude-Code GTM automation.** "Agents vs. workflows" explainers, "Claude Code builds cold-email campaigns in minutes," "run your entire GTM from the terminal." ~67 posts, median 295 / mean 349. This is the 2026 pivot — he re-skinned the whole agency narrative around Claude Code + skills/agents.
3. **LinkedIn content & personal-brand strategy.** How he/ColdIQ turn LinkedIn into pipeline; "let your employees post" evangelism; hook/content-system tactics. ~48 posts, median 277. Meta-content — he uses the channel to teach the channel.
4. **Channel strategy / the future of the SDR / multichannel.** "The SDR role is changing because of AI," GTM-engineer framing, cold-email + LinkedIn + ads orchestration. ~37 posts, median 259.
5. **Signal-based list-building & cold-email fundamentals.** Intent data, "the best B2B data is the one your competition doesn't have," deliverability best-practices, benchmarks. list-building (27) + deliverability (9) + copywriting (8, median 335) + metrics (6) ≈ 50 posts, median ~235-250. Lower reach but highest actionability — this is where the genuinely teachable playbook lives.

Top 10 posts (by likes)

1. **2,794 likes · 801 comments · 37 shares** — listicle/story, agency-business. "*How it started: 4,000 cold emails sent. 1 lead generated. / How it's going: \$4M+ ARR.*" His single best post. Before/after hook, then 6 numbered lessons (list is the strategy → be valuable → write for 1 person → fix deliverability → pair channels → best software), each a mini-principle with a concrete example (HR SaaS/Glassdoor targeting). Closes with a comment-gated 14-page guide P.S. Tone: humble-brag origin story flipped into a teaching frame; warm, first-person, generous.
2. **1,562 · 257 · 56** — listicle, agency-business. "*We just crossed \$400,000 MRR. Here's every tool we use to run our agency:*" Five numbered sections (Content/Outbound/Agency-Mgmt/Inbound/Sales), each a tool dump wrapped in a metric ("100+ leads/month," "35,000 visitors"). CTA is a discussion prompt: "*What's one tool you'd recommend adding?*" Tone: transparent operator, metrics-forward, zero fluff.
3. **1,387 · 217 · 56** — teardown/announcement, agency-business. "*lemlist recently crossed \$34,000,000 ARR. Here's every tool they use to run their SaaS:*" Same 5-section skeleton as his own stack posts but aimed at a bigger, admired company (credibility borrow + a name-drop of CEO Charles Tenot). Ends "*I'm running out of space... Post continued in the comments 📌*" (comment-driver). Tone: insider reporting.
4. **1,172 · 187 · 75** — teardown/announcement, agency-business. "*What our \$4,800,000/year funnel looks like: (It added \$760,000+ in annualized revenue last month)*" Four-stage funnel (Lead Gen → Capture → Management → Conversion), each with tool lists + tactic notes (lead magnets, visitor de-anon, smart forms, VSLs). Credits the graphic designer (Ivan Falco) — a distribution/collab tactic. Highest share count in his top tier (75) — funnels get saved.
5. **1,110 · 182 · 89** — contrarian-take/teardown/engagement-bait, AI. "*AI Agents started replacing employees. Now, they're trusted with corporate credit cards.*" Punchy 2-line hook, a stat ("by 2027, 82% of organisations will rely on

them"), then the contrarian turn: "what many believe is an AI agent... is just a clever workflow." Structured as one task run through 3 escalating scenarios (Non-Agentive → Agentive → true Agent). Highest shares in top 10 (89) — definitional/educational content travels. Tone: teacher clearing up a hyped concept.

6. **1,039 · 3,196 comments · 21** — announcement, AI. "Anthropic just released Claude Design. Our designer Pilar says it's nowhere near Claude Code." Shortest post here (724 chars) but the comment monster (3,196) — a pure comment-giveaway lead magnet (guide link + "comment for it"). Micro-proof stack: 70+ infographics, ~100k organic impressions, "1/5th of the time." Tone: casual flex + free resource.
7. **1,027 likes** — teardown/announcement, agency-business. Second lemlist ARR/funnel teardown ("\$34M ARR funnel... adding \$X"). Reuse of a proven template on a proven subject.
8. **876 likes** — framework/personal, agency-business. "How I'd find my first 10 B2B clients if I had to start from 0: (It's what I've done to hit \$5M+ ARR)" Hypothetical-restart framework — 4 steps (cheap visibility → optimized landing page/VSL → re-engage good-fit prospects by hand → repeat 3 months). Includes a copy-paste DM template. Two P.S. CTAs (tool list link + "want us to build this?"). Tone: mentor-giving-the-playbook.
9. **796 likes** — story/personal, mindset-career. "I turn 31 today. My business made \$557,000 last month. But before that, I failed 7 businesses in a row." Birthday vulnerability hook → 7 failures, each with 🗑️ fail / 🧠 skill learned / ↳ how the skill now prints money at ColdIQ. "You win, or you learn." Every failure quietly cross-sells a current service ("we now offer it as a service too... send a DM!"). His best pure-story post — emotion + stealth pitch.
10. **774 likes** — announcement, promo. "Can you run your entire GTM with Claude Code? We're answering that tomorrow." Webinar promo listing exactly what the live demo covers (Outbound/ABM/RevOps bullets) + the architecture flex ("32 skills, 12 agents & 2,108 files"). Later edited to drop the recording link. Tone: event hype with concrete deliverables.

Top 5 contrarian takes

1. **"What you call an AI agent is just a clever workflow."** His most-repeated and best-performing opinion (posted 4+ times, 1,110 / 459 / 414 top scores). Deflates agent hype while positioning ColdIQ as the people who actually build the real thing.
2. **"Founder: 'I'm afraid to let my employees post on LinkedIn.' Me: 'We added \$700K of ARR with this LinkedIn strategy last month.'"** (395) Argues employees posting grows a personal asset that makes them *stay*, not leave — inverting the standard founder fear.
3. **"The SDR role is changing because of AI — but that makes SDRs more valuable, not less."** (658 / 366) Splits the future into "human skills" vs. "GTM engineers who build systems," rejecting the "AI kills SDRs" narrative.
4. **"Most outbound flops because it's aimed at people who were never going to buy anyway. If your inputs (data/intent) are wrong, it doesn't matter how good your cold email is."** (294) Attacks copy-obsession; reframes outbound as a *data* problem.
5. **"The best B2B data is the one your competition doesn't have — and you can find it for less than \$40/mo."** (316) Anti-database, pro-scraping/custom-signal stance.

End-to-end strategy

- **Cadence:** near-daily, single channel (LinkedIn), single account, single voice — ~20-23/month through 2025. Volume + consistency is the moat.
- **Format mix:** listicle-heavy (44% of posts), with the signature move being the numbered "here's every tool / here's the funnel" teardown. Announcements (27%) and engagement-bait (20%) carry the promo/lead-magnet load. Roughly 35% of posts are copy-paste-playbook or principle actionability; ~63% are example-only or none — i.e., most posts *demonstrate* rather than teach, which keeps the service the real payoff.
- **Hook style:** number/metric in the first line almost every time. Big-number credibility ("\$400K MRR," "\$4.8M funnel," "\$34M ARR"), before/after contrast ("4,000 emails → 1 lead → \$4M ARR"), dialogue hooks ("Founder: ... Me: ..."), and definitional provocations ("what you call an agent is a workflow"). First line is always ≤2 lines and self-contained.
- **CTA / lead-magnet mechanics:** two dominant plays. (a) **Comment-gated guides** — "comment below and I'll send the 14-page guide" (post #1: 801 comments; post #6: 3,196 comments). Comments feed the algorithm *and* build a

DM/email list. (b) **P.S. stacking** — most posts end with 1-2 P.S. lines carrying the real CTA (tool-list link, "want us to build this? → coldiq.com," "book a free strategy call"). The educational body earns the right to the pitch in the P.S.

- **Funnel/monetization:** every "value" post ladders to ColdIQ's service (build-your-outbound / GTM-agents) or a lead magnet that captures email → nurtures. The failure-story and origin-story posts embed "we now offer this as a service too" inside the narrative. Webinars ("run your GTM with Claude Code") convert attention into a live sales event.
- **Engagement tactics:** "continued in the comments 📌" to farm comments; tagging/crediting collaborators (Ivan Falco, Charles Tenot) to borrow reach and credibility; discussion-prompt closers ("what tool would you add?"); reposting his best-performing frameworks with fresh dates (the agent/workflow and SDR posts recur every ~2 months).

Differentiation & verdict

- **What differentiates him:** radical transparency with *real numbers and real tool names*. He doesn't teach abstract "cold email tips" — he shows the actual 40-tool stack, the actual funnel, the actual revenue. It's proof-as-content: the post is the case study for the agency. He also reverse-engineers admired companies' stacks (lemlist), which is lower-effort than original teaching yet higher-credibility.
- **What works (evidence):** (1) Stack/funnel teardowns — agency-business is his top domain by volume *and* median likes (308 vs 273 overall), and holds 4 of his top 8. (2) Comment-gated lead magnets — posts #1 and #6 generated 801 and 3,196 comments, an order above his norm. (3) The recyclable "agent vs workflow" definitional take — reliably 400-1,100 likes across four postings. (4) Big-number before/after hooks — his #1 post (2,794) is exactly this.
- **What hasn't worked / weaker:** deliverability-infra is his lowest domain (median 175, mean 193) — pure technical/tactical posts underperform the flashy stack reveals. list-building-data (median 235) and channel-strategy (259) also sit below his 273 median. Interpretation: the audience rewards *aspiration and voyeurism* (look at this \$5M machine) over *how-to plumbing*. His weakest floor posts (down to 26 likes) tend to be dry tactical or promo announcements without a metric hook.
- **What he avoids:** no carousels-as-primary (image-supported single posts, not doc carousels); no lowercase/edgy-broetry voice — he writes clean, warm, first-person, grammatically proper English; no fear-mongering or pure hot-takes without a teaching payoff; no multi-channel spraying — LinkedIn only; no naked selling — the pitch always rides in a P.S. after value.

Steal for Taha (cold-email/outbound operator, build-in-public)

1. **Publish your own machine as the pitch.** Michel's single best-performing genre is "here's every tool / here's the exact funnel behind our \$XM agency." Taha should post Bleed AI's real stack, real campaign architecture, and real funnel numbers — the transparency is the credibility, and it doubles as a case study prospects can't argue with. (Evidence: agency-business median 308 > his 273 overall; 4 of top 8.)
2. **Lead with a before/after metric hook, pitch only in the P.S.** His #1 post (2,794 likes) is "4,000 cold emails → 1 lead → \$4M ARR." Structure: number-driven hook → numbered teaching body → CTA quarantined in a P.S. Don't sell in the body; earn it.
3. **Run comment-gated lead magnets deliberately.** "Comment '[word]' and I'll send the guide" drove 801 and 3,196 comments on two posts — that's list-building + algorithm reach in one move. Taha can gate a cold-email teardown, a deliverability checklist, or a Claude-Code outbound playbook this way.
4. **Own one recyclable contrarian definition and repost it.** Michel's "what you call an AI agent is just a workflow" earned 400-1,100 likes across four re-postings ~2 months apart. Taha should pick one sharp, defensible cold-email contrarian take (e.g., "volume is dead, signal-based reply rates are 5x") and re-run it on a cadence — proven, low-cost, and it cements a signature POV.

nick-abraham — Founder of Leadbird (2M cold emails/mo, 300+ clients), the "fundamentals over gimmicks" operator-voice of B2B cold email

Snapshot: 544 posts (2025-01-04 → 2026-07-03, ~daily cadence) · median 53 · mean 66 · max 1,257 likes · comments run high (top posts 90–1,643). Domains: copywriting (17.5%), industry-commentary (16.7%), agency-business (15.6%), deliverability-infra (10.8%), mindset-career (8.3%). Format DNA is contrarian-take-first: **contrarian-take 246, personal 109, listicle 104, teardown 96, framework 84, story 69, engagement-bait 59**. Actionability skews principle (269) and copy-paste-playbook (150), not fluff. Tool stack he name-drops: Clay (41), Smartlead (36), Apollo (26), MillionVerifier (18), Claude (16).

Top 5 content pillars (ranked)

1. **Cold-email copywriting & teardowns** — 95 posts, 17.5% share, median 48 likes. Real inbound emails dissected (the barber, "human but 100% automated"), the "3 levels of personalization" framework, hook/offer/CTA mechanics. His most reliable, highest-actionability pillar.
2. **Industry commentary / hot takes** — 91 posts, 16.7%, median 53. Reactions to Apollo changes, "cold email is dead" rebuttals, AI-SDR skepticism, revenue-tier CEO behavior. His engagement engine.
3. **Agency business & positioning** — 85 posts, 15.6%, median 61 (highest median of the big three; owns the #1 post at 1,257). Running Leadbird, tool-spend discipline, pay-per-lead economics, client management SOPs.
4. **Deliverability & infrastructure** — 59 posts, 10.8%, median 47. Domain health, spam filters, inbox rotation, "17 cold email mistakes." The technical-credibility moat.
5. **Mindset / career** — 45 posts, 8.3%, **median 79 — his highest-performing pillar per-post**. Debt-to-multi-7-figures origin story, work-ethic, "AI-proof yourself by learning to close." (Note: promo-announcement at median 92 and linkedin-content at 86 out-index but are too thin — 15 and 13 posts — to be true pillars.)

Top 10 posts (by likes)

1. **1,257 (+108c/3s) · contrarian-take/personal · agency-business**. Tool-spend discipline. HOOK: "So you have \$6,000 of monthly revenue?" / "Yes, Dave." A 4-line scripted dialogue mocking a founder spending \$2,200 of \$6k revenue on Clay credits "because being able to reference prospects' mother's maiden names is what you think is stopping you from growing." Structure: pure dialogue, no commentary, punchline is the last line. Voice: dry, sardonic, insider-mocking. His single best-performing asset — a *format* (fake dialogue) not a lesson.
2. **416 (+169c) · announcement · promo**. HOOK: "I'm excited to share that after 8 years of working closely to develop a relationship with this prospect, we've signed a lifetime agreement!" One sentence. The "8 years" number does the work. Warm, humble-brag. High comment-to-like ratio (celebration bait).
3. **305 (+121c) · announcement/personal · promo**. HOOK: "ANNOUNCEMENT: I am so excited to share I'm now a part owner of Cleverly!" Full-circle story — at 20 he copied Cleverly's animation video, got called out by their co-founder Bruce over email, Bruce became a mentor, now he's part owner. Structure: hook → underdog backstory → the callout anecdote → mentorship → payoff. Warm, vulnerable, self-deprecating ("I got called out immediately").
4. **294 (+951c) · announcement/engagement-bait · list-building**. Free-tool giveaway. HOOK: "Finding a list of perfect-fit accounts is a HUGE pain for outbound marketers. So we built a tool that does it for FREE." Structure: pain → free solution → mild reluctance ("I had to convince the team") → Comment "EMAIL" and I'll DM you the link (must be connected). 951 comments = the comment-to-DM lead-magnet engine.
5. **257 (+1,643c) · announcement/engagement-bait · offers-lead-magnets**. The master-doc giveaway. HOOK: "I NEVER planned on giving this away. We send 2,000,000 cold emails per month for 200+ clients. And for the first time ever..." Cliffhanger opener + credibility numbers → free copywriting frameworks doc → Comment "EMAIL." 1,643 comments — his highest-engagement post ever. Voice: reluctant-generosity + subtle flex ("just make sure you can handle the number of new calls 🤔").
6. **247 (+169c) · story/framework · channel-strategy**. Website-visitor speed-to-lead play. HOOK: "I recently visited a company's site and got hit with a live cold call from one of their reps a few minutes later. I absolutely loved it."

Structure: personal moment → data principle ("faster you call after intent, the more likely they book") → 4-step numbered playbook → *"The future of GTM belongs to those who pick up the phone fastest."* Punchy closing aphorism.

7. **239 (+90c) • listicle/contrarian • industry-commentary.** HOOK: *"How different CEOs respond to cold emails:"* Then three fake quotes by revenue tier — \$1M: *"We don't respond to unsolicited emails. Please remove us."* \$10M: *"Looping in [colleague] to assess fit."* \$100M: *"sure send info."* Format-driven (escalating list), zero commentary, insight is implicit. The higher the revenue, the less precious about cold email.
8. **227 (+31c) • story/personal • mindset-career.** Origin story. HOOK: *"At 19, I got myself into \$30,000 of credit card debt buying courses and coaching to understand how to launch and grow a business."* Structure: rock-bottom (\$1,500/mo gas-station job) → sacrifice → 7-year ladder shown as literal number progression (0→5→10→50→100→300+ clients; \$0→\$10k→\$25k→\$50k→multi-7-fig) → *"the point of this is to just keep going."* Motivational, numbers-as-narrative.
9. **203 (+44c) • story/contrarian • ai-automation.** HOOK: *"I just vibecoded a replacement to a \$99/mo SaaS we pay for."* 3 sentences total: *"It took 15 hours, still has a few bugs I can't get rid of, and will cost us \$80/mo in usage. This is the future."* Ultra-short, confident, "this is the future" close.
10. **199 (+43c/6s) • teardown/contrarian • metrics.** HOOK: *">50% of outbound success is following up (tastefully) until you make the sale or get told to F off."* A real 3-step example (cold call ignored twice, connects on the third 11 days later, 27-min conversation) → principle: *"reach them again 30 days post-initial touch... Just because they aren't ready right now does not mean they won't be eventually."*

Top 5 contrarian takes

1. **"Cold email isn't dead — you're just not trying hard enough."** His #1 recurring stance, proven with the barber cold-email teardowns (190 & 183 likes): *"Cold email doesn't work for my business." BS.* Local services + 3-level personalization + strong offer (free haircut) = it works.
2. **Tool-spend is a vanity trap.** The 1,257-like "Dave" dialogue + *"Overbuilt Clay plays are social flexes; fundamentals beat them at scale"* (134) + *"Bad outbound marketers overbuy tools; success comes from a specific stack, strong offer, social proof"* (106). Fundamentals over gimmicks is his brand.
3. **Most AI-SDR companies are marketing gimmicks** — and the way to AI-proof yourself is to *"focus on the part AI can't replace: sales and closing"* (133).
4. **The "bump" follow-up email is manipulative and overplayed** (119) — *"use better offers and real, strong emails instead."* Against a near-universal cold-email convention.
5. **Network with your competitors* (122) — "TAM is effectively infinite and friendships matter more than one deal." *Plus:* "LinkedIn reply-rate screenshots are worthless"* (102) — attacks the vanity-metric flex culture of his own niche.

End-to-end strategy

- **Cadence:** ~daily for 18 months (544 posts). By his own #8 post, "Posted content every single day" is a stated 7-year discipline — consistency is the strategy.
- **Format mix:** Contrarian-take is the default wrapper (45% of posts), then he layers a *device* on top: fake dialogue (#1), fake quote-ladders (#7), real-email teardowns (#4-copywriting), or numbers-as-narrative origin stories (#8). Short posts massively over-perform — his #1 (249 chars) and #9 (174 chars) are among the shortest.
- **Hooks:** Three repeatable molds — (a) **contrarian slap:** *"Cold email is dead." BS.*; (b) **reluctant reveal:** *"I NEVER planned on giving this away..."*; (c) **scene-drop:** *"I recently visited a company's site and got hit with a live cold call..."* He almost never opens with a question or a stat alone.
- **CTA / lead-magnet mechanics:** The comment-to-DM engine. *"Comment 'EMAIL' and I'll DM you the link (must be connected)"* — the "(must be connected)" forces a connection request. Two of his top 5 posts (free doc, free tool) generated 951 and 1,643 comments this way. He gates lead magnets behind engagement + connection, weaponizing the algorithm.
- **Funnel/monetization:** LinkedIn authority → free tool/doc → connection + DM → Leadbird agency (+ now part-owner of Cleverly). Credibility is quantified in every proof post: *"2M cold emails/mo," "300+ clients," "15M+ emails sent."*

- **Engagement tactics:** Announcement/milestone posts (lifetime deal, ownership stake) harvest congratulations-comments; fake-dialogue and quote-ladder formats bait "tag someone who does this"; hot takes bait debate.

Differentiation & verdict

- **Differentiator:** The *operator-who-actually-runs-the-machine* voice. Not a guru selling a course — a founder sending 2M emails/mo who mocks the guru economy from the inside ("overbuilt Clay plays are social flexes"). Credibility is volumetric and constant.
- **What WORKS (evidence):** (1) Fake-dialogue / quote-ladder formats — his #1 (1,257) and #7 (239) are format plays, not lessons. (2) Comment-gated free lead magnets — 951 and 1,643 comments. (3) Vulnerable origin/full-circle stories — mindset-career is his highest-median pillar (79) and the Cleverly ownership story hit 305. (4) Brevity — sub-250-char posts punch far above weight. (5) Real-email teardowns — the barber appears twice (190, 183) because concrete beats abstract.
- **What HASN'T worked as well (evidence):** Pure deliverability/infra content is his lowest-median big pillar (47) despite being technically valuable — too dry to spread. Straight tactic posts (median in the 40s) underperform his stories and hot takes. Depth ≠ reach; the audience rewards attitude and format over how-to.
- **What he AVOIDS:** Vanity reply-rate screenshots (explicitly calls them "worthless"), the manipulative "bump" follow-up, over-engineered Clay flexes, and hype around AI-SDR tools. He also avoids long technical walls of text as hero content.

Steal for Taha (cold-email / outbound, build-in-public)

1. **Weaponize the format, not just the lesson.** Taha's best shot at a Leadbird-1,257-style outlier isn't a better tip — it's a *device*: a fake founder-dialogue, a "how different [ICP tiers] respond to cold emails" quote-ladder, or a real-inbox teardown. Package Bleed AI insight inside a repeatable format and it travels.
2. **Comment-gate a genuine lead magnet with "(must be connected)."** Nick's two biggest posts gave away a copywriting master-doc and a free ICP tool via *Comment "EMAIL"* — netting 950–1,600 comments AND forced connection requests. Bleed AI has real assets (calculator, frameworks) to gate this exact way. It's the single most transferable mechanic here.
3. **Be the anti-gimmick operator, loudly.** His entire brand is "fundamentals over tool-flexing." Taha can own the same lane against the AI-SDR hype: name the gimmicks, then show the volume/results Bleed AI actually ships. Contrarian-slap hooks ("Cold email is dead.' BS.") + quantified proof ("we send X/mo") is the exact recipe, and it doubles as differentiation from every "I automated my whole GTM with Clay" post.
4. **Mine your own inbox and origin.** His most durable content is a real barber email he received (used twice) and his \$30k-debt-to-7-figures story. Taha should teardown real cold emails Bleed AI sends/receives, and tell the founding-numbers story as a literal progression ladder — concrete + vulnerable outperforms abstract advice every time.

atishay-hyperke — Founder of Hyperke, "one of India's largest cold email agencies," selling deliverability-at-scale as a science

Atishay is a Chennai-based agency founder (ex-Amazon/AWS) who has built his personal brand as the **volume-and-deliverability operator** in cold email. His angle: he isn't a "personalization guru" — he's the guy who has "sent over 20 million cold emails in 5 years," is a **certified Smartlead expert / top 1% of 87,000 users**, and runs the boring infrastructure and list-architecture that lets you send 100K–2.6M emails/month without torching domains. Every post ladders back to two proof anchors (20M emails sent, top-1% Smartlead plaque) and one villain (agencies that lean on "fancy" AI personalization instead of relevance + infra). Lately he is pivoting the brand toward **"GTM engineer"** as the new identity/role he hires and trains for.

Snapshot: 186 posts (2025-01-26 → 2026-07-03) · likes **median 21 · mean 31 · max 154 · min 1** · Domains: agency-business (30), industry-commentary (21), ai-automation-tooling (20), deliverability-infra (19), metrics-benchmarks (19), list-building-data (14), mindset-career (13), offers-lead-magnets (13), promo (12), copywriting (12) · Formats:

contrarian-take (72), case-study (49), announcement (38), personal (31), framework (28), listicle (27), story (25),

Top 5 content pillars (ranked 1–5)

1. **Agency ops & the "GTM engineer" identity** — hiring/sourcing/training, systems-SOPs, positioning. ~30 posts, ~16% share, median ~35 likes (his highest-median non-promo pillar; the GTM-engineer field-manual post hit 146).
2. **Deliverability & infrastructure at scale** — domain health, rotation, spam gateways (Barracuda/Proofpoint), Google/Azure/SMTP redundancy. ~19 posts, ~10% share, median ~17 likes but produces his biggest bangers (122, 100, 95).
3. **AI/automation tooling** — his custom cold-email "Gem"/GPT, Clay + Claygent enrichment, Claude Code. ~20 posts, ~11% share, median ~35 likes (top pillar for consistent virality: 148, 101).
4. **Metrics & scale case studies** — "we sent X emails → Y replies → Z demos," PCPL benchmarks, volume tiers. ~19 posts, ~10% share, median ~13 likes but the outliers (99, 95) carry it.
5. **List-building & anti-personalization copy doctrine** — "80% of effort on list building," in-market targeting, SMB rule-breaking. ~26 posts (list-building 14 + copywriting 12), ~14% share, median ~15–26 likes.

Top 10 posts (by likes)

1. **154 likes (+564 comments, 0 shares)** · announcement + engagement-bait (lead-magnet drop) · Re-release of his cold-email AI "Gem" V2. **HOOK:** "500+ people asked for my cold email AI gem last time." · Structure: social-proof (paste DM quotes "the script writer was fire") → "V1 → now V2" → numbered 5-feature list → "Comment 'V2' + connect" → DM. Tone: hype-drop, insider, FOMO. **Note the comment-to-like ratio (3.7x) — pure keyword-comment farming.**
2. **148 (+631c, 0s)** · announcement · Custom Gemini-3 cold-email Gem giveaway. **HOOK:** "I've sent over 20 million cold emails in the last 5 years. And I finally found an AI that writes them better than I do..." · Structure: credential hook → agitation ("they all have the same problem: can't stay under 70 words / avoid spam / sound human") → "Until Gemini 3" → bulleted feature list → "Comment 'GEM'" → PS credential ("certified Smartlead expert... books 400-600 appointments/mo"). Tone: authority + reveal.
3. **146 (+533c, +3s)** · announcement + tactic · Free "GTM engineer field manual." **HOOK:** "A good GTM engineer can COMPLETELY turn a company around in 90 days (or less)." · Structure: role-hype → contrarian pain ("most job posts mention 'Clay' and think it'll do the job") → numbered failures the bad hire can't do → 8-part manual TOC → "comment 'GTME' + connect" → **double PS incl. "REPOST for priority access."** His most sophisticated lead magnet — sells a hiring rubric to founders (his buyers), not tactics.
4. **129 (+12c, +1s)** · story (pure, no CTA) · **HOOK:** "Writing this at 4:51 am from the Phi Phi islands, still thinking about Smartescape." · Name-drops GTM peers at a Smartlead villa retreat; "conversations you don't get on LinkedIn." Tone: status/belonging flex. Note the collapsed comments (12) — earns reach via aspiration, not keyword-bait.
5. **122 (+306c, 0s)** · case-study + tactic (lead magnet) · **HOOK:** "We booked 51 appointments with enterprise companies in 6 months. Dow Jones. STUSSY. Georgia State University." · Structure: named-logo proof → "the client failed 4-5 times before" → thesis ("the SINGLE difference: can you land in the inbox... Barracuda/Proofpoint auto-filter 99%") → 6-bullet Notion-doc contents → "Like + comment 'system'." Tone: technical authority.
6. **101 (+198c, 0s)** · announcement + case-study · Cold-email evaluator GPT giveaway. **HOOK:** "Our cold email campaigns generated 14,900 leads and were Top 1% in terms of replies from among 87,000+ Smartlead users." · Structure: proof → honest confession ("even our best copywriters struggled") → 7 check-mark features → results ("181,000 in placement fees" client) → "Comment 'Cold Email Evaluate'." Same GPT lead magnet, re-skinned (recurring engine).
7. **100 (contrarian + framework)** · **HOOK:** "Sending 10K cold emails/month is NOT the same as sending 100K+/month." · Best-structured teardown: myth ("10x what's working") → math (10K=40 leads/\$160K vs 100K=133 leads/\$532K → "extra \$372K JUST by accepting diluted metrics") → 5 numbered scale problems (fingerprinting, compressed testing, rotation, inbox ops, lead reuse) → "500K" playbook CTA. Tone: numbers-first educator.
8. **99 (+engagement-bait) case-study** · **HOOK:** "We sent 65,419 cold emails for a SaaS company in the hardest niche I've ever touched. We STILL booked 57 qualified demos off 277 replies." · Niche = "agencies serving

HVAC/plumbers... already get 20 cold emails a day." Funnel math (1 lead per 236, 21% reply-to-appt) → "Comment 'SATURATED'." Tone: underdog-wins-in-saturation.

9. **95 case-study + announcement · HOOK:** "We just sent 2.6 MILLION cold emails in just 14 days. That's more emails in 2 weeks than many people send in 1 year." · 4-step how ("110+ segments, 10+ angles/day, 1000s of inboxes, Smartlead + custom monitoring") → "why don't other agencies do this? They don't have the infra/team that LIVES in deliverability metrics. We do." → "Comment 'VOLUME'" → PS teases "10,000,000+ emails for 1 client in June." Tone: dominance flex.
10. **89 story + personal · HOOK:** "In my 2nd year of college, I googled what it actually takes to be in the top 1% of the world. The trajectory my parents mapped out was NOT going to get me there." · Amazon/AWS → "threw away my job → all in on agency → 7 figures, team of 15." Close: "Always bet on yourself." Tone: origin-story vulnerability; his one reliably viral non-cold-email format.

Top 5 contrarian takes

1. **"Commission-based cold email almost NEVER works. The upfront work is the product."** — The research/enrichment/offer-testing/infra weeks before a single send are where "the vast majority of results come from"; commission deals attract corner-cutters. (46 likes)
2. **"For 9/10 people, using AI is costing them deals."** — Wrong way = AI-written copy (generic, hallucinated Clay first lines, "prospects get 10 AI emails a day that all sound identical"). Right way = "Use AI to build better lists and better offers... Put AI where it compounds. The email itself is a small fraction of the process." (46)
3. **"We don't try to make our emails feel good. We try to make them RELEVANT."** — Attacks the personalization-industrial complex (AI first lines, dynamic images, personalized videos): "if they're not in market, no amount of 'I noticed you posted about X' will make them care... It's why we spend 80% of our effort on list building." (82)
4. **"Scaling isn't linear — your relative returns tank but absolute profit explodes."** — Accept worse reply rates and higher cost-per-lead because "\$372K more" comes from volume; "if you have an offer that works RIGHT NOW you MUST put it in front of every customer as fast as possible — in 6 months your window closes." (100)
5. **"A GTM engineer is NOT someone who writes sales copy or builds offers in a deck."** — Redefines the role as marketer-who-learns-pipes U engineer-who-learns-buyer-psychology; positions himself as the authority who hires/trains the category. (43)

End-to-end strategy

- **Cadence:** high-frequency, near-daily (186 posts / ~18 months). Steady drumbeat, no long gaps.
- **Format mix:** contrarian-take is the backbone (72/186 ≈ 39%) — he leads with a myth-buster, then layers a case study or framework. Roughly **1 lead-magnet drop per week** wrapped in a fresh case study; punctuated by ~monthly personal/origin stories for reach beyond the cold-email niche.
- **Hooks:** three repeatable molds — (a) **credential shock** ("I've sent over 20 million cold emails"), (b) **big-number case study** ("2.6 million emails in 14 days," "51 appointments with Dow Jones/STUSSY"), (c) **contrarian negation** ("X is NOT the same as Y" / "AI is costing you deals"). Named enterprise logos and exact figures (65,419; 14,900; PCPL 441) do the credibility lifting.
- **CTA / lead-magnet mechanics:** the engine is **comment-a-keyword + connect → DM the asset**. Keywords: "V2," "GEM," "GTME," "system," "VOLUME," "SATURATED," "deck," "500K," "AI," "Cold Email Evaluate." Assets are always **his own reusable IP** (a custom GPT/Gemini Gem, a Notion doc, a Smartlead workshop deck) — the *same* AI Gem is re-dropped repeatedly under new framings. This manufactures the huge comment counts (300–630 comments on top posts) that game LinkedIn's algorithm, while the "connect if we're not linked" step converts reach into first-degree network + DM pipeline.
- **Funnel/monetization:** free asset → DM conversation → "want this done-for-you? DM me / we'll see if it's a fit" retainer. He explicitly refuses commission deals (retainer-only). Social proof is outsourced ("check the video interviews on our website" — Stephen Gardner "60%+ close rates," Bradley Benner "5 clients first month"). Secondary monetization = **recruiting/employer-brand** via the GTM-engineer content (hiring trial GTM engineers, training talent).
- **Engagement tactics:** keyword-comment bait; "REPOST for priority access"; multi-PS stacking (PS + PSS with teasers, like "10M emails in June, follow along"); status flexes (Smartlead plaque, Phi Phi villa retreat, peer name-drops) to

Differentiation & verdict

- **Differentiator:** He owns the **"deliverability + volume + list-building science"** lane while everyone else fights over personalization/copy. His moat is *credibility of scale* (20M emails, top-1% Smartlead, 2.6M/14 days) plus concrete infra vocabulary (fingerprinting, Barracuda/Proofpoint, domain rotation, PCPL, Google/Azure/SMTP redundancy) most creators can't speak fluently.
- **What WORKS (evidence):** (1) The **reusable AI-Gem lead magnet** — same asset drove his two biggest posts (154, 148) and a third (101) across a year; comment counts of 564/631 prove the keyword-comment mechanic dominates the algorithm. (2) **Named-logo enterprise case studies** (122 likes, Dow Jones/STUSSY) — specificity converts. (3) **Money-math contrarian posts** (the \$372K scaling post, 100 likes) — teaching with real economics outperforms platitudes. (4) **Origin story** (89) is his best non-tactical reach play.
- **What HASN'T (evidence):** median is only 21 and mean 31 — the corpus is **top-heavy**; the daily contrarian/metrics posts largely land in the low teens (metrics-benchmarks median 13, copywriting median 15, deliverability median 17). Pure benchmark/reply-rate posts (median 12) and generic industry-commentary (21 posts, median 19) underperform relative to effort. High output ≠ high average.
- **What they AVOID:** carousels/heavy design (image-light, text-driven); teaching the *how* for free without gating behind a DM; commission/performance pricing; and — pointedly — the personalization-AI narrative. He avoids self-deprecation except in the controlled origin-story format, and never posts without a proof number attached.

Steal for Taha (cold-email / outbound, build-in-public)

1. **Build ONE reusable, gated IP asset and re-drop it under fresh framings.** Atishay got 154 + 148 + 101 likes and ~1,300 comments from essentially the *same* cold-email GPT, re-hooked each time. Taha should package Bleed AI's actual sending framework into a single "Gem"/Notion doc and run the **comment-a-keyword → connect → DM** loop weekly — it doubles as a warm-lead capture funnel, not just reach.
2. **Lead with money-math, not adjectives.** His best educational post converted a scaling argument into "\$160K vs \$532K → extra \$372K." For build-in-public, translate Bleed AI's own numbers (emails sent, reply%, PCPL, pipeline \$) into a before/after economic story per post — specificity + named logos (with permission) is what earns the 100+ engagement, not clever copy.
3. **Attack the crowded narrative to own an unclaimed lane.** He beat the "personalization" crowd by championing "relevance + 80% on list-building." Taha can pick the *un-owned* contrarian position in Bleed's niche (e.g., signal-based over volume, or infra over copy) and hammer it consistently — the negation hook ("X is NOT the same as Y") is his single most reliable format (39% of posts).
4. **Mix ~monthly origin/status stories to escape the niche echo chamber.** The 4:51am Phi Phi retreat (129) and the "googled the top 1%" story (89) outperformed most tactical posts and pulled non-buyers. Taha should periodically post the founder journey / behind-the-scenes to build the *person* brand that makes the tactical lead magnets convert.

richard-illingworth — Cold-email infrastructure operator who teaches deliverability as the hidden variable, monetized through comment-to-DM lead magnets

Richard Illingworth runs **Premium Inboxes** (inbox infrastructure at scale — "250,000+ inboxes for 2,000+ cold email teams"). His angle: everyone obsesses over copy; he's the guy who tells you the reason your campaign is dead is the *plumbing underneath it* (DNS, warmup, provider splits, AI pre-send filters). He wraps deep technical authority in a scrappy, lowercase, British ("mate," "brother," "f*ck it") builder voice, then converts attention with high-frequency free lead magnets gated behind "comment X + connect with me."

Snapshot: 900 posts (2025-03-03 → 2026-07-03, ~2/day) · likes median **17** · mean **22.1** · max **171** · Domains:

deliverability-infra 33%, copywriting 18%, industry-commentary 17%, mindset-career 14%, agency-business 4% Page 24 of 49

Top 5 content pillars (ranked)

1. **Deliverability & infrastructure** — 295 posts · **32.8% share** · median 15 likes. His moat: DNS/SPF/DKIM/DMARC, warmup schedules, provider splits (70/30 vs 50/50), AI pre-send checkpoints, throttling detection. High volume, moderate per-post engagement — but the *authority anchor* for everything else.
2. **Copywriting** — 158 posts · **17.6%** · median 17. Opener teardowns, one-sentence pitch, CTA fixes, "give-to-ask" ratio. His second-highest-signal pillar (56, 41, 33-like contrarians).
3. **Industry commentary / hot takes** — 150 posts · **16.7%** · median 18. "Is outbound dead," guru critiques, "cold email is spamming" rebuttals. Cheap to produce, reliably above-median.
4. **Mindset / career** — 127 posts · **14.1%** · median **19** (his highest-median core pillar). Personal stories (Monaco injury, coasting-on-a-snowball, \$150k mentorship), work-ethic, invest-in-yourself. Humanizes the technical brand.
5. **Agency business** — 39 posts · **4.3%** · median 17, **mean 28.5** (highest mean of the big pillars). SOPs, systems, "\$100k/mo," agency-owner-misery takes. Low volume, high payoff — where his buyer actually lives.

Outlier: **ai-automation-tooling** (15 posts) has by far the best engagement — median **41**, mean **52.8** — driven by the "I fed Claude Opus my system" post. AI-framed content massively overperforms his baseline.

Top 10 posts (by likes)

1. **171 (+91c)** · engagement-bait meme · *"nobody: / cold emails in 2025: / hey, you, me, meet? / 5 minutes. promise. / k thnx. / lmaooo!"* — HOOK is the whole post. Structure: 5-line meme skit, zero CTA. Tone: self-deprecating, in-group. His single most-liked post is a *throwaway joke about his own industry* — reach ≠ business value.
2. **166 (+672c, 8 shares)** · announcement/lead-magnet · Hormozi teardown. HOOK: *"I studied Alex Hormozi's cold outreach for 72 hours... And broke down his playbook that grew Acquisition.com to \$250M+/year."* Structure: authority-borrow → "everyone's doing it wrong" (3 arrows) → 5-bullet "what's inside" → "Comment 'Alex'" → PS "repost for priority access." Highest comment count in the set — borrowed celebrity authority is his top comment engine.
3. **156 (+15c)** · personal story · Monaco taxi injury. HOOK: *"freak shit can happen to anyone / got out of a taxi in Monaco..."* Short, raw, principle: take nothing for granted. Tone: vulnerable, no CTA. Note the 15 comments vs 557 below — pure-personal gets likes, not conversation.
4. **156 (+557c)** · AI announcement · HOOK: *"I fed Claude Opus 4.6 my cold system behind \$10M+ in B2B deals / (and turned it into a 10-day action plan for you)."* Structure: "advice is scattered across 47 YouTube videos and 12 threads" pain → Day 1→Day 10 numbered sprint → bonus cheatsheet → "Comment 'SPRINT' + send a connection request." Tone: authoritative-generous. The AI framing + day-by-day scannability is his best-converting template.
5. **136 (+639c)** · contrarian + lead magnet · HOOK: *"just pull a list from Apollo / i've NEVER seen a successful cold emailer that only uses Apollo."* Structure: myth → mechanism ("torch every inbox you spent 18 days warming up") → 7-method intent stack with named tools (Apify, RB2B, Clay) → 5-bullet package → "free for the next 48 hours, comment 'LEADS'" → "PS steal this." Highest-signal top post.
6. **133 (+644c)** · SOP giveaway · HOOK: *"Hey cold email agency owners and freelancers, let me save you 3 years."* Direct ICP call-out → "3.5 years... one big document" → 7-bullet contents → "Comment 'SOP'" → "scale to \$100k/mo faster." Tight, benefit-loaded.
7. **132 (+49c)** · contrarian hot take · HOOK: *"cold email is spamming" / mate, / all sales is spamming."* Structure: reframe (content/ads/DMs are all "spam") → anaphora *"it's not spamming when it's honest, true, and well delivered... it's real value."* No CTA. Pure belief-defense of his category.
8. **129 (+121c)** · guru-critique story · HOOK: *"Someone DMed me to say I'm 'doing LinkedIn wrong' / Offered to fix it for \$2k/mo."* Structure: setup → receipt (his critic's posts get "2 likes, 0 likes, 1 like") → concession → principle: *"if you can't make it work for yourself, why would I let you touch mine?... be your own best case study."* → "What's your thoughts?" engagement question.
9. **126 (+399c)** · teardown lead magnet · HOOK: *"I just analyzed 237 cold email campaigns from our 10 biggest clients. / Without knowing it, they all followed the same formula."* Curiosity-gap listicle (4 hidden variables never revealed) → "like this post, comment 'FORMULA'." Number-in-hook proof play.

10. **125 (+376c)** · lead magnet · HOOK: "I've spent 3+ years studying why 90% of cold emails fail / And why 10% are successful." → the one-sentence-pitch thesis → "I could ask \$499 for this. But you get it free today" → "comment 'PITCH'." Classic price-anchor-then-free.

Top 5 contrarian takes

1. **"Your offer is fine. It's your ask that fcks it up."** — Kills the offer-obsession; the CTA ("Let me know if that's of interest") is the leak. "Bad asks don't get rejected. They get ignored. Which is worse."
2. **"STOP splitting your inboxes 50/50 between Google and Outlook — that's costing you upwards of 50% of your budget."** — "Diversification and insurance are two separate problems... when you buy a car you don't ask the dealership 'does that include insurance?'" Reframes a near-universal deliverability default as a mistake.
3. **"I'd rather have 100 leads showing intent signals than 10,000 contacts."** — "I scraped 10,000 contacts off Apollo' — that's a glorified domain-burning exercise." Your list is ~80% of the outcome, yet people spend 80% of time on copy. Run 100 sniper emails before scaling.
4. **"Infrastructure is STILL the number one reason campaigns underperform — your open rates are cratering and you're blaming your copy? Mate. It has nothing to do with what you're writing."** — The core thesis of his entire brand.
5. **"Cold email isn't spam — all sales is spam... it's not spamming when it's honest, true, and well delivered. Real value makes the difference."** — Category defense; converts objection into permission.

End-to-end strategy

- **Cadence:** ~2 posts/day, 900 in 16 months. Volume-first, deliberately disposable — many low-signal quips/hot-takes buffer a smaller core of high-value giveaways.
- **Format mix:** contrarian-take is the dominant wrapper (69% of posts carry it), but *announcements convert*: announcement median 36 vs overall 17. He uses cheap hot-takes/memes for reach and reserves the packaged-asset "announcement" for lead capture.
- **Hooks:** (a) myth-in-quotes + hard reversal ("just pull a list from Apollo' / i've NEVER seen..."); (b) borrowed authority ("I studied Alex Hormozi's... / I fed Claude Opus my system"); (c) number-proof ("237 campaigns," "250,000+ inboxes," "90% fail"); (d) direct ICP call-out ("Hey cold email agency owners..."); (e) price anchor ("I could ask \$499... free today").
- **CTA / lead-magnet mechanics:** Near-identical every time — **"comment [KEYWORD] + connect/send a connection request so I can DM you."** Keywords: Alex, SPRINT, LEADS, SOP, FORMULA, PITCH, INFRA, Gemini, INSURE. The connection-request requirement is the real play: each magnet farms new 1st-degree connections (future DM audience). Frequent **"repost for priority access / repost and I'll ALSO send [bonus]"** to juice distribution. **"Free for the next 48 hours"** manufactured scarcity.
- **Funnel/monetization:** Free asset (built from real ops data) → comment/connect → DM → nurture toward paid infra audit / Premium Inboxes. He explicitly signals the paid product inside the free giveaway: *"i charge for a cold email infrastructure audit. but fck it, here's everything for free."* The giveaways ARE the top of the funnel for a done-for-you inbox service.
- **Engagement tactics:** Curiosity gaps that never resolve in-post (the "237 campaigns" never reveal the 4 variables), "What's your thoughts?" open questions, receipts/screenshots, self-deprecating memes about his own industry, and vulnerable personal stories to break up the technical stream.

Differentiation & verdict

- **Differentiator:** He owns the **infrastructure/deliverability lane** as the *root cause* narrative — "you're blaming your copy; it's the plumbing." Backed by a genuinely defensible data moat ("250,000–360,000 inboxes in circulation," "237 campaigns," "100+ B2B teams"). Everyone else sells copy; he sells the thing copy sits on.
- **What WORKS (evidence):** AI-framed authority posts (ai-automation-tooling median **41** vs 17 overall; the Claude Opus post = 156 likes/557 comments). Packaged-asset announcements (median 36, mean 43). Borrowed-authority hooks (Hormozi = 672 comments, his highest). Named-tool specificity (the Apollo/7-method post, 136 likes, high signal). Number-in-hook proof consistently overperforms.

- **What HASN'T (evidence):** His most-liked post (171) is a throwaway meme with **91 comments and zero CTA** — reach with no business capture. Personal/injury stories pull likes but *kill conversation* (Monaco: 156 likes / only 15 comments; \$150k mentorship: 116/23) — good for humanization, useless for lead flow. Pure hot-takes ("cold email is spamming," 132 likes / 49 comments) generate agreement, not pipeline. His median is only 17 despite 900 posts — most content is disposable filler; a small fraction does the work.
- **What he AVOIDS:** No carousels/heavy design (text-native). No polished corporate voice — deliberately lowercase, profane, conversational. Doesn't reveal the actual tactical payload in-feed (gates it behind the DM). Rarely posts without either a hot-take or an asset — almost no "neutral" educational middle.

Steal for Taha (cold-email / outbound / build-in-public)

1. **Weaponize the data moat as content.** Richard turns operational exhaust into authority: "237 campaigns analyzed," "250,000 inboxes." Bleed AI has real campaign data, reply rates, and deliverability results — package "I analyzed [N] Bleed AI campaigns and they all did X" as recurring number-in-hook posts. Proof beats opinion, and it's un-fakeable by competitors.
2. **The comment→connect→DM lead-magnet loop is the whole engine — copy the structure exactly.** Contrarian hook → mechanism → specific packaged asset (SOP, checklist, swipe file) → "*comment KEYWORD + send a connection request so I can DM you*" + "*repost and I'll also send [bonus]*." The connection-request gate quietly compounds his DM-able audience every post.
3. **Sell the give-to-ask ratio in outbound itself.** His highest-signal copy takes ("give before you ask, give twice as much as you take") validate Bleed AI's own play — lead cold emails with a specific asset (a 2-min Loom teardown, an industry checklist), not "I'd love to help you scale your outbound." Fix the *ask*, not just the offer.
4. **Own a root-cause narrative competitors ignore.** Richard's entire brand is "it's not your copy, it's your infrastructure." Taha should pick the one under-discussed variable Bleed AI is best at (e.g., signal-based list-building / intent stacks — note Richard's own "list is 80% of the outcome, 100 intent leads > 10,000 Apollo contacts") and hammer it as *the* hidden reason outbound fails in 2026.

nikita-maildoso — Founder-led category evangelist for cold-email infrastructure (SMTP mailboxes)

Nikita is CEO of **Maildoso** ("Cold Email Infrastructure | Scale your outreach with unmatched deliverability"). His entire LinkedIn play is **founder-as-category-educator**: he doesn't teach copywriting or list-building as an end — he teaches *deliverability infrastructure* to convert the market away from Google/Microsoft mailboxes and toward private SMTP (his product). Angle = "the honest insider who has the data": high-transparency, data-cited, myth-busting, wrapped around a relentless free-inbox giveaway loop.

Snapshot: 119 posts (2025-01-06 → 2026-07-02) · likes **median 33 / mean 46.7 / max 283** · Domains: deliverability-infra 34%, promo-announcement 27%, copywriting 9%, industry-commentary 8%, mindset-career 5%, agency-business 3% · Formats: announcement 44, contrarian-take 39, engagement-bait 24, story 14, personal 14, teardown 12, listicle 11, case-study 9. Tools name-dropped: Maildoso (58), Instantly (7), Clay (3), Google Workspace (3), Saleshandy/Smartlead/Apollo (2 each). Nearly every post routes back to Maildoso.

Top 5 content pillars (ranked)

1. **SMTP-vs-Google deliverability gospel** (deliverability-infra, ~34% of corpus, median ~36 likes, max 189). The core thesis engine: "SMTP inboxes are trash" is a myth, warm-up tools are financially incentivized to push Google, custom-domain-tracking rebuilt to allow links/images. Highest-volume *and* highest-ceiling educational pillar.
2. **Free-inbox giveaway promos** (promo-announcement, ~27%, median 33, max 283). "300 free inboxes, comment X" — engagement-bait lead-gen machine repeated monthly with escalating numbers (300 → 50,000).
3. **Crisis-transparency / build-in-public founder stories** (agency-business + the blacklist saga, small volume but high engagement, median 57 on agency-business). The blacklisting near-death narrative told twice (L189, L88).

4. **Industry commentary / "relax, the market is fine"** (~8%, median 37, max 118). Google-won't-kill-cold-email, "I got a cold email from Google."
5. **Copywriting & tactical deliverability tips** (copywriting 9% + list-building, median ~26). TLD diversification, registrar-doesn't-matter, .com myth — lower engagement, positions expertise.

Top 10 posts (by likes)

1. **283L (12c/6s)** · announcement · *Wes Foster live-session promo, "grow your agency with cold email."* HOOK: "How to grow your agency with cold email." Structure: title → guest credential → 4 bulleted "how to" benefits → date/time → event link. Tone: clean corporate event flyer. (Note: highest-liked post is a co-marketing borrow of another's audience — reach ≠ his own thesis.)
2. **273L (724c/2s)** · announcement + engagement-bait · *300 free SMTP inboxes.* HOOK: "This is going to be expensive and time-consuming, but f*k it." Structure: profane pattern-break → "FREE, no strings" → objection ("SMTP is crap") → proof (Eric Nowoslawski 4X reply lift, "hundreds of thousands of emails") → "if it worked for Eric it'll work for you" → CTA (like + comment "SMTP" + connect) → quirky PS. Tone: brash, confident, borrowed-authority. The 724 comments = his single biggest engagement event.
3. **253L (39c/1s)** · story + personal · *Leaving Russia for Uruguay.* HOOK: "In 2022, I left Russia and moved to Uruguay. The Russo-Ukrainian war made it impossible to stay." Structure: vulnerable narrative → language-learning grind (5am Duolingo, "felt like I'd closed a Series A") → new life → soft invite "come visit us in Montevideo." Tone: raw, literary, no CTA/no product — pure human-brand equity.
4. **189L (64c/5s)** · story + personal · *The blacklist crisis, v1.* HOOK: "I've been asked this question many times this week. Is Maildoso going to go bankrupt? Here's what happened..." Structure: crisis admission ("six figures' worth of domains useless overnight") → cause → response (safeguards, cheaper TLD replacements, layoffs) → defense of .click TLDs → "bounce back stronger." Tone: humble, radically transparent CEO.
5. **160L (88c/5s)** · promo/contrarian · *Links & images now safe in cold email.* HOOK: "No Links, no images, no videos in a cold email? Now Maildoso has changed the rules of the game 🚀." Structure: conventional-wisdom setup → "But not with Maildoso 🤖" → "secret sauce" reveal → benefit bullets → "Isn't that cool?" Tone: emoji-heavy, hype, product-forward.
6. **146L (16c/4s)** · story + announcement · *"Accidentally fully booked my calendar."* HOOK: "This is how my team accidentally fully booked my calendar with meetings..." Structure: origin-of-a-new-product-offer story → self-deprecating ("reply rate is meh... positive reply rate is even worse 🤖") → "you can do that too" → coaching-program CTA (link in comments). Tone: candid, imperfect-numbers honesty.
7. **124L (302c/3s)** · announcement · *300 free inboxes, "but there's one catch."* HOOK: "Maildoso is giving away 300 inboxes for free to EVERYONE... but there's one catch (some of you are going to hate this):" Structure: curiosity-gap catch → "we're only giving away SMTP" → data-authority ("after selling hundreds of thousands of inboxes") → CTA (comment "SMTP" + like). Tone: confident insider. The parenthetical "some of you are going to hate this" is his sharpest hook device.
8. **120L (41c/0s)** · announcement · *3,000 users milestone.* HOOK: "Today, we've officially passed 3,000 users!" Structure: milestone → gratitude → "just the beginning." Tone: warm thank-you. Pure social-proof marker.
9. **118L (54c/2s)** · story/industry-commentary · *"I got a cold email from Google."* HOOK: "I have received a cold email 🐼🐼🐼 From Google 🤖." Structure: micro-post, 5 short lines, punchline ("They probably have the most successful cold email campaign ever. No issues with spam filters 🎯"). Tone: witty one-liner — validates cold email as legit by pointing at Google doing it.
10. **108L (25c/8s)** · announcement · *Saleshandy partnership.* HOOK: "We're excited to announce our partnership with Saleshandy." Structure: partner intro → integration benefit → "maximum deliverability." Tone: corporate PR. (Tied at 108L with the "Do you send video in your cold email? 🤖" engagement-bait one-liner, 138c — his highest comment-to-like ratio.)

Top 5 contrarian takes

1. **"SMTP inboxes are trash is a myth"** — and the reason it persists is a conspiracy of incentives: *"The warm-up tools need you buying Google mailboxes. That's their business model. If everyone switched to SMTP, their biggest revenue*

stream disappears." (L87). Claims side-by-side tests show SMTP beats Google "not by a little, by a lot," and 15-20% (sometimes 4x) higher primary-inbox rates (L61).

2. **"Everyone obsesses over reply rates. The real winners just scale and book meetings."** — cites an agency at a 0.2% reply rate who was "already crushing it" because he scaled hard; infrastructure, not reply rate, is the lever (L40).
3. **"I run a cold email company. I'm supposed to tell you cold email is the answer to everything. It's not."** — argues against single-channel dependence: winners run cold email + ads + content + events (L53). Rare self-undercutting take from a founder.
4. **"Google won't kill cold email — it's too good a business."** — "in 2025... they made over \$100M, probably closer to \$200M" on inbox sales, holding ≥50% of a \$400-500M mailbox market, so "just relax" (L65).
5. **"Registrar / .com doesn't matter."** — "alternatives like .app, .co, .pro, .net, and .click perform just as well" managing 20,000 domains; TLDs under \$4/yr are normal; diversify (L46, L39). Directly self-serving (his replacement domains are cheap TLDs) but framed as data.

End-to-end strategy

- **Cadence:** High-frequency, 119 posts over ~18 months (~1.5/week, denser in 2026). Escalating giveaway drumbeat.
- **Format mix:** Announcements + contrarian-takes dominate (~70% combined). He alternates a *long educational/transparency post* with cheap *one-line engagement-bait* ("Do you send video? 🤖"). Personal stories (Russia/Uruguay, blacklist) are the rare emotional spikes that build brand equity with zero CTA.
- **Hooks:** Best-performing devices are (a) **the shameful-catch parenthetical** — "but there's one catch (some of you are going to hate this)"; (b) **profane pattern-break** — "but f*k it"; (c) **crisis question** — "Is Maildoso going to go bankrupt?"; (d) **insider-conspiracy reveal** — "That's what the warm-up tools want you to believe."
- **CTA / lead-magnet mechanics:** The signature engine is **"free inboxes → comment a keyword + like + connect → team DMs you in 24-48h."** Keywords rotate ("SMTP", "300", "SCALE"). Requiring a *connection request* is the clever mechanic — it converts a like into a DM-able lead and grows his network simultaneously. The giveaway is the funnel: free 30-day inbox trial → onboarding → paid conversion.
- **Funnel/monetization:** LinkedIn is top-of-funnel for a product-led-growth SaaS. Free trial (300 inboxes/30 days, connect to your own domains, "no strings") de-risks the switch from Google. Secondary monetization: coaching program add-on (post #6). Borrowed authority (Eric Nowoslawski, Saleshandy integration) supplies proof.
- **Engagement tactics:** Comment-to-DM keyword bait; asking open questions ("What channels are you running?"); manufactured curiosity gaps; deliberately *unflattering honesty* ("reply rate is meh... positive reply rate is even worse") to read as credible.

Differentiation & verdict

- **Differentiator:** He owns a *narrow, technical, contrarian wedge* — "private SMTP > Google mailboxes" — that almost no other cold-email creator defends (most creators sell Google/Workspace-based infra). He is the loudest anti-consensus voice on inbox infrastructure, backed by operator-scale data claims (20,000-tens-of-thousands of domains, ~1,000 isolated infra accounts).
- **What WORKS (evidence):** (1) **Free-inbox giveaways** — his two biggest engagement posts are giveaways (273L/724c, 124L/302c); the mechanic reliably prints comments and DM-able leads. (2) **Radical crisis transparency** — the blacklist confession hit 189L/64c and the retell 88L; admitting near-bankruptcy *built* trust rather than eroding it. (3) **Personal non-product stories** — Russia/Uruguay at 253L with zero CTA proves human-brand posts outperform most promos. (4) **Borrowed authority** — naming Eric Nowoslawski's 4X lift did more lifting than any self-claim.
- **What HASN'T (evidence):** (1) His *own* pure product-hype posts underperform his educational/story ones — the "secret sauce 🤖" emoji promo (160L) trails his transparency posts, and generic PR (Saleshandy 108L, 3,000-users 120L) are middling. (2) **Median is only 33 likes** despite CEO status — the corpus is heavily bottom-loaded (min 4L); volume of low-signal one-liners drags the average. His ceiling is high but consistency is low. (3) Repetition risk: the identical giveaway with a swapped keyword shows diminishing novelty.
- **What they AVOID:** Long tactical how-to teardowns of copywriting/sequencing (he stays in his infra lane); competitor-bashing by name ("I won't name anyone, specifically"); polished perfection — he leans into messy

Steal for Taha (cold-email/outbound, build-in-public)

1. **Run a keyword-comment + connection-request lead magnet.** Taha's version: "Comment 'AUDIT' and connect — my team will send you a free teardown of your cold-email deliverability within 48h." The *require-a-connection* twist turns a like into a DM-able lead and grows the network. This is Nikita's single most reliable engine (724 and 302 comments).
2. **Weaponize transparency about a near-failure.** Nikita's blacklist-crisis posts (189L, 88L) outperformed almost all his promos. Taha should tell a real "campaign that nearly tanked / client we almost lost and how we rebuilt the system" story — the vulnerability *is* the differentiator and builds more trust than any case-study brag.
3. **Borrow authority, don't self-claim.** "Eric Nowoslawski saw a 4X lift" did more than any Maildoso self-praise. Taha should lead with a *named client's* metric, not Bleed AI's own adjectives.
4. **Pick one contrarian wedge and hammer it with data.** Nikita's whole brand is "SMTP > Google, and here's the incentive-conspiracy why." Taha needs one repeatable heretical thesis (e.g., "volume is dead, signal-based is 5x reply") stated with operator numbers, restated monthly from new angles — consistency of a single POV beats scattered tips.

aidan-collins — LinkedIn lead-gen operator who sells "packaging over content"

Aidan Collins is a young B2B LinkedIn ghostwriting / lead-gen agency owner (works from southern Spain, came up "sending desperate DMs on Upwork" 2 summers prior). His whole angle: the LinkedIn algorithm changed and now only rewards **lead-magnet giveaway posts + hyper-specific DM outreach** — not "value posts" or "building in public." Nearly every post is itself a lead magnet ("comment X and I'll DM it to you"). He sells the meta-skill: how to package and give away resources on LinkedIn to book calls.

Snapshot: 279 posts (2025-03-03 → 2026-07-03) · median **14** likes · mean **21.1** · max **180** · comments routinely dwarf likes (top post: 180 likes / **822 comments**; #2: 149 / **1,168 comments**) — a signature of the comment-to-DM mechanic. Domains: linkedin-content (192/69%), mindset-career (16), industry-commentary (15), promo (15), offers-lead-magnets (19). Formats: contrarian-take (122), listicle (72), personal (63), announcement (55), framework (55), story (48), case-study (28), engagement-bait (27), teardown (19). Actionability skews copy-paste-playbook (79) / principle (124). Tools name-dropped: Sales Navigator (13), Claude/Claude Code (18), Instantly (9), ChatGPT (5), Clay (3).

Top 5 content pillars (ranked)

1. **Contrarian takes / algorithm commentary** — $n \approx 123$, share ~44%, median 13 likes. "Value posts are dead," "consistency is bad advice," "stop treating LinkedIn like a slot machine." His volume engine and hook generator.
2. **Personal-brand / origin story** — $n \approx 99$, 35%, median 13 (mean 20.7). Childhood-bedroom-to-Spain redemption arcs; humanizing proof that his system works.
3. **DM outreach / appointment setting** — $n \approx 91$, 33%, median 12. "Specificity beats volume," 45%/35%/10 funnel math, 5-message frameworks.
4. **Content / hooks / viral mechanics** — $n \approx 85$, 30%, median 13. Swipe hooks, study current winners, packaging teardowns.
5. **Lead-magnet / offer construction** — $n \approx 25$ explicit, 9%, median 15 (**mean 27.1 — his highest-converting pillar**). The 12 lead-magnet types, scorecards, naming formulas, "packaging is the whole game." Small share, biggest payoff — plus every other pillar routes into a lead magnet CTA. Promo/announcement (15 posts) and AI-tooling (8, mean 31.8) are small but punch above weight.

Top 10 posts (by likes)

1. **180 (822 comments, 1 share) · contrarian-take + announcement · "one concept beats 99% of LinkedIn."**

Complete Orphan: Teardown / Bleed AI
HOOK: "How did this post get 50k impressions?" My client just asked me this. He thinks I'm a magician. I'm not. Page 30 of 49

Structure: quoted-client hook → "algorithm COMPLETELY changed" → kills 'value posts' and 'building in public' → teases the ONE concept → metric stack (367k impressions/20 days, 0→350 Skool members, 5 calls from 1 post) → 4-part training bullets → CTA "comment METHOD." Tone: cocky-authoritative, "magician" framing, FOMO.

2. **149 (1,168 comments) · story + announcement · Claude Code + Reddit trend-scraper.** HOOK: "*Claude Code + Reddit is making me go completely viral on autopilot. (steal my ENTIRE workflow + .MD file completely free)*" Structure: transformation (45min-2hr → 2 min) → metric stack (10-20 calls/mo, ~2x following) → 4 arrow-bullets of how it works → "single markdown file, no API keys" → CTA "comment TRENDS + connect" → PS "reach is down for 99.999%." Tone: builder-flex, generosity framing.
3. **98 (515 comments, 2 shares) · case-study + tactic · "27 sales calls in 48 hours for a client."** HOOK: "*We just booked 27 sales calls in 48 hours for a client... All with 1 LinkedIn post (steal the playbook for free).*" Structure: result → "most people rarely book calls" → 2 missing factors (copy psychology + backend funnel) → "the PACKAGING is the only variable" → 7-item numbered resource list → CTA "comment KIT + connect" → PS "REPOST and I'll prioritize your DM." High-signal, deep specificity.
4. **97 (339 comments, 1 share) · contrarian + listicle · the 45/35/10 DM funnel.** HOOK: "*For every 800 connection requests I send: 45% accept, 35% reply to my DM, and 10 book in for a sales call.*" Structure: his funnel vs "95% of others" (15%/10%/0-1) → "you're not alone" empathy → specificity thesis (bio/posts/about/location) → "the difference is 100% in the humanity" → 6-item SOP CTA "comment SOP." Data-forward, side-by-side contrast layout.
5. **85 (42 comments, 2 shares) · contrarian + personal · "worst advice: just be consistent."** HOOK: "*some of the worst advice i've ever gotten: 'just be consistent and you'll get there one day.' this kept me stuck for NINE MONTHS.*" Structure: bad-advice frame → his stuck stats → "started playing the game" → new stats (1,200 followers/2wk, 7 calls/1 post, 900% impressions) → 5-arrow "what actually works" (study winners, swipe hooks) → TL;DR. All-lowercase, confessional. Notably low comments — no lead-magnet CTA, pure thought-leadership.
6. **79 (147 comments, 1 share) · listicle + announcement · "12 BEST lead magnet types."** HOOK: "*After 2xing my agency size & following with LinkedIn lead magnets... Here are the 12 BEST types for going viral + driving inbound.*" Structure: bare numbered list (Notion library, custom GPT, prompt library, swipe file, templates...) → proof (1,000+ calls, millions in pipeline) → CTA "comment library" for the Notion vault. Ultra-scannable, 606 chars.
7. **78 (284 comments, 1 share) · engagement-bait · "376,216 impressions in 20 days / 5 Claude prompts (free)."** HOOK: exact-number flex + "(free)." Structure: reality-check on algorithm → list crowded niches (cold email, ads, consulting) → "you NEED lead magnets → hand-raisers → calls" → 5 numbered prompts → CTA "comment MAGNET + connect" → PS "exact prompts my 6-7 figure ghostwriting clients use."
8. **78 (33 comments) · story + personal · "2 summers ago, childhood bedroom."** HOOK: "*2 summers ago, I was crammed in my childhood bedroom / Sending DESPERATE DMs on Upwork for 4-6+ hours/day / Would've dove into the trash for a \$200 project.*" Structure: rock-bottom → "fast forward" → dozens of clients, south of Spain → "it costs literally \$0 to bet on yourself." Pure emotional inspiration, no CTA — proof there's a person behind the systems.
9. **77 (216 comments, 7 shares) · case-study + announcement · "client closed \$42,000 in ~20 days, gets 5-10 likes/post."** HOOK: "*My client closed \$42,000 in revenue in ~20 days from LinkedIn. He gets 5-10 likes per post (maybe).*" Structure: anti-vanity-metric contrarian ("that's why we don't focus on content") → 3-step DM system → 35%+ reply rates with \$10M ARR targets → full playbook giveaway → CTA "comment DMs" → PS repost-for-bonus-GPT. Highest shares in the top 10.
10. **76 (100 comments) · contrarian + personal · "AppSumo founder gave his Twitter to an AI agent."** HOOK: "*The founder of AppSumo gave his twitter account to an AI Agent.*" Structure: news peg → speculation ("2 years down the line, social platforms might just be bots talking to each other") → "not entirely sure how I feel." Pure low-effort commentary/engagement-bait, no CTA — rides a trending story for reach.

Top 5 contrarian takes

1. **"'Value' posts are dead."** "*The 'value' posts that you take 45 minutes to draft... They don't work anymore. The 'building in public' pieces you're SO proud of... Snore. Unless you're a top 1% prodigy, people will not care about what you have to say.*" Only lead-magnet giveaways win now.
2. **"Consistency is the worst advice."** "*consistency without a focus on optimization will lead to failure. if you post generic content for 1,000 days in a row... you MIGHT gain like 10 followers.*" Study winners and swipe, don't just show

3. **"Don't focus on content — likes are a vanity trap."** *"He gets 5-10 likes per post (maybe)... people obsess over going viral and getting thousands of likes, but they're not actually closing deals. That's why we don't focus on content."* Revenue over reach.
4. **"Packaging is the whole game, not the resource."** *"same exact resource... but 20x the comments"* (40→1,158 comments by changing only the image + hook). *"if a lead magnet ever flops, look at the image first. it's almost never the resource."*
5. **"You literally CAN'T win with normal effort / specificity beats volume."** *"most people STILL treat LinkedIn DMs like cold email blasts... What you miss out in volume you make up in SPECIFICITY."* Average effort yields below-average results; hyper-personal DMs beat automation blasts. (Bonus macro-take: top founders will abandon cold email for a "compounding, indefensible audience moat.")

End-to-end strategy

- **Cadence & format mix:** high-frequency posting; ~44% contrarian hot-takes as reach fuel, ~35% personal-story for trust, ~33% DM/outreach tactics, and a steady drip of lead-magnet giveaways as the money posts. Short posts (often 600-1,600 chars), heavy whitespace, one idea per line.
- **Hooks:** four repeatable molds — (a) quoted objection ("How did this post get 50k impressions?"), (b) exact-number flex ("376,216 impressions in 20 days," "27 calls in 48 hours," "\$42,000 in ~20 days"), (c) bad-advice/contrarian ("worst advice I've gotten," "STOP treating LinkedIn like a slot machine"), (d) rags-to-riches origin ("2 summers ago, childhood bedroom"). Almost always paired with a parenthetical "(steal it free)."
- **CTA / lead-magnet mechanics — his core loop:** post teases a specific packaged resource → **"comment [KEYWORD]"** (METHOD, TRENDS, KIT, SOP, MAGNET, PLAYBOOK, library, MEDIA) → **"connect with me so I can DM you"** → manual/automated DM delivery. Single-keyword comments create **herd-behavior social proof** (why comments hit 500-1,168 while likes stay ~100-180). Repost incentive ("repost and I'll prioritize your DM" / bonus GPT) juices distribution.
- **Funnel/monetization:** LinkedIn giveaway post → comment → DM with resource → DM conversation using his "5-message specificity framework" → booked call → agency/ghostwriting/lead-gen retainer. Newsletter (700 subs, "\$0 on ads, every sub from commenters") + a Skool community (0→350 from one post) are secondary capture layers. Resources are Notion vaults, custom GPTs, prompt packs, swipe files — cheap to produce, positioned as "\$50 products."
- **Engagement tactics:** deliberately trades likes for comments (comments = DM permission + reach signal); news-jacking (AppSumo AI agent); big round metrics; "connect with me" doubles as list-building.

Differentiation & verdict

- **Differentiator:** he doesn't sell content — he sells **the packaging + distribution system for lead magnets**, and he *demonstrates* it live: every post is a working example of the thing he's teaching. The "packaging > resource" thesis (proven with the 40→1,158 same-magnet A/B) is his signature, defensible insight.
- **What WORKS (evidence):** the comment-keyword-DM loop generates absurd comment-to-like ratios (822, 1,168, 515 comments) → those are his top posts. Case-study hooks with hard numbers (\$42k, 27 calls/48hr) drive shares (7 shares on the \$42k post). Lead-magnet pillar has the highest mean likes (27.1) despite lowest volume. AI-tooling posts (Claude Code workflow) mean 31.8 — riding the AI wave works.
- **What HASN'T (evidence):** pure thought-leadership with **no CTA** underperforms on the metric he actually monetizes — the "consistency" post (85 likes) got only 42 comments; the childhood-bedroom story (78 likes) 33 comments; both starve his DM pipeline vs. lead-magnet posts pulling 500+. Low-effort commentary (AppSumo, 76 likes/100 comments) gets reach but no leads. Overall median is modest (14 likes) — the account is built on a **few outlier lead-magnet spikes**, not consistent broad reach.
- **What he AVOIDS:** carousels/heavy design; long "value" essays; generic "building in public"; automation-blast DMs; competing on posting volume for its own sake; paid ads (brags "\$0 on ads").

Steal for Taha (cold-email / outbound / build-in-public)

1. **Turn every LinkedIn post into a keyworded lead magnet, not a thought-leadership essay.** Taha sells cold email — package "the exact 5 prompts / Clay table / swipe file / scorecard" and gate it behind **"comment KEYWORD +**

connect." The comment pile *is* the reach engine and the DM opt-in list. (Dovetails with Bleed AI's existing lead-magnet-per-post rule.) (Caveat: Taha still needs authority content — don't take aidan's "kill all value posts" to the extreme; balance magnets with the build-in-public + proof pillars.)

2. **Lead with case-study numbers framed as a giveaway.** "We booked 27 calls in 48 hours — steal the playbook free" > "here's how cold email works." Taha has real reply-rate/booked-call data; wrap it as a packaged SOP with a 6-7 item bulleted contents list so the free resource *feels* like a \$50 product.
3. **His "specificity beats volume" DM thesis validates signal-based outbound.** "*What you miss in volume you make up in SPECIFICITY — bio, posts, about, location.*" That's the LinkedIn twin of Bleed AI's signal-based-cold-email pitch. Use his 45/35/10 vs 15/10/0 funnel-contrast format as a hook template for outbound content.
4. **Packaging A/B is the cheapest lever.** Same resource, new image + hook = 20x comments. For Taha, the outbound offer/subject-line/first-line packaging matters more than the underlying asset — worth systematizing swipe files of scroll-stopping media + subject lines rather than endlessly rebuilding deliverables.

josh-braun — Sales-trainer and cold-outbound coach who turns anti-pushiness psychology into daily micro-parables

Snapshot: 3,500 posts analyzed (Jan 2025 → Jul 2026) · median **56** likes · mean **104** · max **4,442** · min 1. Primary domains: **mindset-career (1,631 / 47%)**, **sales-calls-closing (782 / 22%)**, **copywriting (521 / 15%)**, industry-commentary (286), linkedin-content (116). Typical formats: **contrarian-take (1,795 posts / 51%)** and **personal (1,550 / 44%)** dominate, layered onto **story (934)**, framework (471), and teardown (397). Voice is short-line, one-thought-per-line "broken" layout — never brick paragraphs. Volume is extreme (~180 items/month, likely folding in reposts); the durable pattern is 1–3 original posts/day.

Top 5 content pillars (ranked 1–5)

1. **Sales-mindset parables / detachment philosophy** — ~1,631 posts (47%), median **56**, but owns nearly every mega-hit. Life-observation stories (a boots meeting, a kid ordering dinner, a Sunday email) that ladder into one sales/life principle: detach from outcome, autonomy is sacred, presence beats pitch. Highest ceiling by far (max 4,442). *Rank 1: biggest volume AND all six top posts.*
2. **Cold-call & objection reframing** — ~782 posts (22%), median **57**, max **1,680**. "Zone of Resistance," "shift intent from selling to understanding," say "Okay" and hang up. Tactical but wrapped in psychology, not scripts-for-scripts'-sake.
3. **Cold-email copywriting frameworks** — ~521 posts (15%), median **51**, max **1,250**. Reusable, copy-paste plays: "dropped the ball?" ghost-recovery email, deposits-vs-withdrawals follow-ups, "poke the bear" questions, the 4T email. Highest *actionability* pillar (652 posts tagged "copy-paste-playbook").
4. **Industry commentary / guru-critique hot-takes** — ~286 posts (8%), median **54**, max **1,145**. "Volume is dead, intent wins," trust is eroding, calling out bad "objection-handling" advice and predatory platforms.
5. **LinkedIn/personal-brand + AI-culture riffs** — ~116 linkedin-content posts (median 58) plus AI-anxiety humor (the em-dash post, "Claude can't create a memory"). Small volume, disproportionate virality when it taps a shared creator grievance.

Top 10 posts (by likes)

1. **4,442** likes · 230c · 19s — *personal/story, mindset*. His mother's death reframed as a lesson in support-through-questions. HOOK: **"My mom died yesterday."** Structure: story → dialogue ("What's one fond memory you have of your mom?") → one-line principle. Broken layout, heavy white space. Tone: raw, tender, disarming.
2. **3,608** · 202c · 89s — *contrarian, mindset*. Why top reps quit. HOOK: **"Here's why high-performing sales reps leave."** Structure: staccato cause list → marathon-runner analogy → prescription ("Reward them with ownership"). Tone: blunt, righteous, manager-scolding.
3. **3,213** · 200c · 50s — *story, mindset*. The yellow-boots/loud-socks memory vs. automated sequences. HOOK: **"When I was younger in sales, I'd get on a plane and go meet people."** Story → turn → aphorism: "Claude can write a

sentence. I can't create a memory." Tone: nostalgic, warm, anti-automation.

4. **3,096** · 595c · 41s — *story/contrarian, mindset*. The "Not urgent. Read Monday." boss. HOOK: **"I had a boss who loved sending Sunday emails."** Relatable-grievance story → "schedule the damn email." Highest comment count of the ten. Tone: wry, indignant, funny.
5. **2,957** · 128c · 71s — *contrarian, mindset*. A tighter rewrite of #2 three months later (same marathon analogy, same payoff). HOOK: **"Here's why top reps leave."** Proof he re-runs winners. Tone: same blunt register, condensed.
6. **2,903** · 111c · 24s — *story, mindset*. 6-year-old orders for the whole table. HOOK: **"I saw a family of five at a restaurant do something I'll never forget."** Observation → "he was practicing confidence... before a boardroom." Tone: heart-warming, parental.
7. **2,419** · 182c · 44s — *story, mindset*. Starbucks pickup line as a discovery-questions masterclass. HOOK: **"I was at Starbucks and overheard a guy approach a girl."** Dialogue → "The best way to be interesting is to be interested." Tone: observational, charming.
8. **2,212** · 346c · 62s — *personal/contrarian, AI-culture*. HOOK: **"I can't use an em dash anymore. This is very upsetting for me."** Comedic riff, escalating to "This is how civilization ends. Not with a bang. With a comma I didn't want to use." Tone: deadpan, self-deprecating, absurdist.
9. **2,091** · 133c · **139s** — *contrarian, mindset*. Sales volatility. HOOK: **"One month, you're on fire. The next, you're questioning all your life choices."** Highest share count — a "save/send-to-a-rep" motivational piece. Tone: stoic, coaching.
10. **1,680** · 215c · 37s — *contrarian/teardown, sales-calls*. The "just say 'Okay' and hang up" objection reframe. HOOK: **"Cold calling tip. Seller: 'You're probably going to hate me because this is a cold call...'"** Bad-script vs. his-script teardown → "abundance mindset, not scarcity." Tone: contrarian, teacherly.

Top 5 contrarian takes

1. **"Handling objections is the problem."** Say "Okay" and hang up. "Whenever prospects feel pressure, they enter the Zone of Resistance... Your job isn't to talk everyone into a conversation. It's to find people who are open to talking." (1,680)
2. **"Selling isn't about convincing."** *"That word — into — is the problem... Your job is to create the conditions for people to convince themselves."* Persuasion by subtraction. (1,556)
3. **"Sales isn't a meritocracy — it's tilted."** Top performers and gurus got lucky on timing (Zoom in the pandemic); "if you sold Zoom during the pandemic you were crushing quota" isn't skill. (1,475 / 1,504)
4. **"Rewarding your best rep with a bigger quota is a punishment."** Escalating targets, not the work, cause burnout. (3,608)
5. **"Volume is dead; intent wins."** *"Cadence volume matters less than intent — send fewer, more relevant touches"*; treating a prospect's truth as an objection isn't a conversation. Directly against the spray-and-pray orthodoxy. (805 / 1,380)

End-to-end strategy

- **Cadence:** Ships daily, often multiple times/day — an always-on volume machine. Consistency + surface area is a core lever.
- **Format mix:** ~50% contrarian-take, ~44% personal, half of those also stories. The signature move: **a non-sales life anecdote (restaurant, Starbucks, a plane trip) that pivots into one sales principle**. Only ~15% is hard-tactical copywriting; the emotional/philosophical content carries reach, the tactical content carries authority and lead value.
- **Hook style:** First line is a complete, curiosity-loaded sentence — a confession ("My mom died yesterday"), a promise ("Here's why top reps leave"), or a scene ("I was at Starbucks..."). Never a stat, never a "3 tips" list-hook. One thought per line, aggressive white space, "broken" layout.
- **CTA / lead-magnet mechanics:** Soft and rare. Most posts end on an aphorism, not a CTA. Lead value is delivered *inside* the post as give-away tools — "here's an SDR calculator," "I analyzed 387 cold calls, here's the slideshow," ChatGPT prompts you can copy. The "deposit not withdrawal" philosophy is literally his own distribution model.
- **Funnel/monetization:** Book chapters shared for feedback, tool mentions (ChatGPT, ZoomInfo, Clay, Instantly Calendly) — but he sells the *philosophy* (his training/newsletter) not a SaaS. The frameworks are top-of-funnel; the

mindset is the brand.

- **Engagement tactics:** Dialogue/script re-enactments ("Prospect: ... Seller: ..."), analogies (marathon runner, flower blooming), and comment-bait grievances (Sunday emails drew 595 comments). He openly **recycles winners** — #2 and #5 are the same post re-cut months apart, both 3K+.

Differentiation & verdict

- **What differentiates him:** He's an *anti-tactics* tactician in a niche flooded with scripts, sequences, and volume hacks. Where the Nick Abraham / Eric Nowoslawski crowd post infrastructure and deliverability, Josh posts *psychology and restraint* — "poke the bear," "shift intent to understanding," "detach from outcome." He runs the market's strongest **story-to-lesson engine**; almost nobody else consistently opens with a non-business anecdote.
- **What WORKS (evidence):** Emotional/philosophical parables with a one-line payoff → all 10 top posts are mindset stories, none is a tactical teardown. The "reframe a familiar grievance" formula (Sunday emails 3,096; em-dash 2,212) reliably prints. Cross-domain analogies and dialogue re-enactments dramatically outperform straight advice. Recycling proven posts works (3,608 → 2,957 on a rewrite).
- **What HASN'T worked / flops:** Pure **promo/announcements** are his weakest content — median 37, mean 48 (vs. 56/104 overall); the action-figure and book-chapter posts underperform his stories 15–20×. **Offers-lead-magnets** also sag (median 47). Straight **frameworks** (median 50) trail stories (median 61). The moment he asks for something or over-indexes on mechanics, reach drops.
- **What he AVOIDS:** Hard CTAs, "book a call" asks, listicle hooks, stat-led openers, brick paragraphs, jargon, hustle-culture bravado. He avoids *pitching* on-platform — consistent with his own "make a deposit, not a withdrawal" doctrine.

Steal for Taha (cold-email/outbound operator, build-in-public)

1. **Open with a non-business scene, land on the outbound lesson.** Taha's build-in-public wins become the parable, not the pitch: a real prospect reply, a domain that got burned, a rep's Sunday-email panic → one principle ("volume is dead; intent wins"). This out-earns "3 deliverability tips" posts by an order of magnitude in Josh's data.
2. **Ship give-away tools as the lead magnet, delivered inside the post.** Josh's most-shared/most-saved mechanic is "I analyzed 387 cold calls — here's the slideshow" and copy-paste prompts. Taha's equivalent: "I audited 200 cold emails that got replies — here's the pattern," or a ready-to-steal Clay/Instantly recipe.
3. **Adopt the "dropped the ball?" ghost-recovery email as inspiration for outbound follow-ups.** Subject "dropped the ball?", own the fault, "you don't owe me anything," ask for feedback not a meeting — Josh claims ~100% response on the humility-feedback follow-up (1,250 likes). Directly deployable in Bleed AI's sequences and re-ping flows.
4. **Reframe the category as anti-pushiness, and recycle your winners.** Taha's contrarian edge in a spam-saturated market is "fewer, signal-based, respect-autonomy" messaging — the exact wave Josh rides. And when a post hits, re-cut it 2–3 months later (Josh's #2/#5 both cleared 3K on the same idea).

charles-tenot — lemlist's growth exec turned LinkedIn "operator-philosopher"

Charles Tenot is a French go-to-market executive (ex-CFO/COO/CRO/CEO across tech; now a growth/GTM leader in the lemlist / lempire orbit, working alongside founder Guillaume Moubache). His angle is **operator credibility, not tactics**: he posts as a battle-scarred revenue leader delivering opinionated takes on how companies actually run — sales leadership, remote culture, AI hype, and the future of outbound ("Smartbound") — with lemlist/Claap woven in as soft product proof. He rarely teaches a playbook; he sells a worldview and lets the tool ride along.

Snapshot: 270 posts (Jan 2025 → Jul 2026, ~15/month, near-daily) · median 130 likes · mean ~194 · max 1,325.

Comments run high (top posts 73–190). Domains skew **mindset-career (26%), industry-commentary (20%), promo-announcement (19%), agency-business (16%)**. Formats: **contrarian-take (122), personal (114), announcement**

(90), story (67), plus engagement-bait (20), case-study (16), listicle (13), teardown (12). ~65 posts touch lemlist

Top 5 content pillars (ranked)

1. **Leadership & mindset / "how great operators behave"** — the core. mindset-career, 70 posts, **26% share, median 135 likes** (mean 241 — his single biggest hits live here). CRO/VP-of-Sales archetypes, work ethic, accountability, "stay close to the customer."
2. **Industry hot-takes & guru/media critique** — industry-commentary, 55 posts, **20% share, median 111**. Reacting to Deel, Klarna, CNBC, AI-replaces-humans narratives. Pure engagement fuel.
3. **Company/product announcements** — promo-announcement, 51 posts, **19% share, median 148** (highest median of the big pillars). Claap acquisition, lemHouse, lemlist features. Milestone + vision framing.
4. **Agency/GTM business systems** — agency-business, 42 posts, **16% share, median 132**. Positioning, SOPs, revenue milestones, client acquisition.
5. **Cold email / copywriting teardowns** — small volume (copywriting 4 posts) but **highest median 250 / mean 447** — his single most efficient format when he does it (the "1,000 emails" teardown hit 1,310).

Top 10 posts (by likes)

1. **1,325 (171c/14s)** · personal + contrarian-take · CRO is the hardest job. HOOK: *"I've been CFO, COO, CRO, and CEO of tech companies - and I can tell you this: CRO is the hardest job—even harder than CEO."* Structure: credential flex → Bezos quote he rebuts → arrow-list of "it's okay if..." failures vs the one unforgivable ("miss growth targets") → "brutal" reframe → take → *"Agree? Disagree?"* Tone: authoritative, weary insider, debate-baiting close.
2. **1,310 (159c/13s)** · teardown + engagement-bait · cold-email teardown. HOOK: *"I receive over 1,000 prospecting emails this month. I replied to just his one. Here's why it's good:"* Structure: arrow-list of what the winning email did right → "could it be even better? Yes" balanced critique → soft lemlist plug ("we're help you fix this at lemlist... AI writer gets sharper every week") → *"Simple wins 🙌"*. Tone: generous-expert, low-ego, product plug feels earned.
3. **1,164 (73c/7s)** · contrarian-take + listicle · average vs great VP of Sales. HOOK: *"I've worked with 5 different VPs of Sales. Here's what separates the great from the average:"* Structure: two mirrored arrow-lists (average / great), lemlist smuggled into the last "great" bullet → reverent close. Tone: pattern-recognition authority.
4. **1,128 (190c/16s)** · contrarian-take + engagement-bait · Deel's messy CRM. HOOK: *"Deel is doing \$800M in ARR. Yet, their CRM is still a mess."* Structure: named-company proof → "SaaS is dead / AI replaces everything" strawman → rebuttal (room for good software) → *"is 2025 the year of clean CRMs or not yet?"* Tone: dry, "it's funny," bullish-on-software. 190 comments — his top comment-driver.
5. **1,079 (86c/7s)** · personal + contrarian-take · remote work. HOOK: *"If your employees are lazy at home, they'll be lazy at the office."* Structure: name the enemy (RTO mandates) → "Wrong." → arrow-lists of fake-work vs what actually works (ownership, talent density, trust) → lemlist proof (remote-first, opened an office) → *"No pressure. No control. Just trust."* Tone: punchy manifesto.
6. **961 (78c/52s)** · story + personal (French) · his partner's autism-daycare startup "Poulpi." HOOK: *"Il y a 3 ans, ma compagne a quitté un poste en Fusions & Acquisitions pour tenter de changer le monde..."* Structure: personal stakes → bureaucratic hell → concrete impact metrics → "en danger" → societal-cost math → CTA to sign petition. **52 shares — his most-shared post**; emotion + cause travels.
7. **858 (98c/14s)** · story + contrarian-take · faked CRM notes. HOOK: *"A CRO recently shared how he faked data in his CRM to improve sales performance - and it's mind-blowing."* Structure: context → problem (demoralizing lead notes) → "genius" move (AI-rewrite notes positive) → result ("7X better") → takeaway (*"Hack your mindset, and you'll 10X your performance"*). Tone: story-with-a-twist.
8. **857 (61c/12s)** · contrarian-take · CNBC/Mistral gaffe. HOOK: *"When CNBC confuses a laundry brand with a leading French AI company 🤖"* Structure: absurd real event → arrow-list indictment of shallow media → "the system is broken" → kicker. Tone: righteous, French-pride undertone.
9. **844 (76c/3s)** · story + personal · kindness in business (Guillaume Moubeche). HOOK: *"When I was a kid, I thought you had to be a badass to win in business. Then I started working with Guillaume Moubeche and he proved otherwise."* Structure: numbered list of 6 concrete "kind" acts → *"Morale: you can be a 100\$M+ entrepreneur while treating people very well."* Tone: warm founder-worship, receipts-backed.

10. **710 (113c/9s)** · announcement · Claap acquisition. HOOK: *"Big news: we just bought Claap to change how sales teams will operate forever."* Structure: past → shift ("2025, outreach is no longer about volume, it's timing") →

problem (conversations are a black box) → product demo scenario → coin the category "Smartbound" → "In 3 years this will be the standard... LFG 🚀". Tone: vision-caster.

Top 5 contrarian takes

1. **"CRO is harder than CEO."** Inverts Bezos ("being a CEO is easy") and the org chart — everything else can slip, only growth can't.
2. **"If your employees are lazy at home, they'll be lazy at the office."** Frontal attack on RTO mandates: surveillance ≠ productivity.
3. **"SaaS is not dead / AI won't replace everything"** — proven by a \$800M-ARR company (Deel) that still can't keep a clean CRM.
4. **"Sales is mindset over skill"** — a CRO faked positive CRM notes with AI and those leads converted 7X better. Belief manufactures performance.
5. **"You can be a \$100M+ entrepreneur while being genuinely kind"** — long-term trust beats hardball. Anti-"ruthless founder" trope.

End-to-end strategy

- **Cadence:** near-daily, ~15/month, sustained 18 months — high consistency.
- **Format mix:** dominated by **contrarian-take + short personal reflection**. The reliable engine is a 1-line polarizing hook → mirrored arrow-lists (average vs great / do this not that) → one-line moral. Stories and announcements are the peaks; hot-takes are the steady base.
- **Hooks:** (a) **credential flex** ("I've been CFO, COO, CRO, and CEO..."), (b) **big-number contrast** ("Deel does \$800M ARR. Yet their CRM is a mess", "1,000 emails, I replied to one"), (c) **named-company reaction** (Klarna, CNBC, Deel), (d) **belief-reversal** ("When I was a kid I thought..."). First line is almost always a complete, quotable claim.
- **CTA / lead-magnet mechanics:** notably **soft**. No downloadable lead magnets, no "comment X for the guide." CTAs are either **debate prompts** ("Agree? Disagree?") to farm comments, or **product plugs framed as help** ("we help you fix this at lemlist"). The one hard CTA is cause-driven (sign the Poulpi petition) — and it earned his highest shares.
- **Funnel / monetization:** classic **executive-as-distribution** for lemlist/lempire and Claap. He doesn't sell himself; he builds authority that halos the product. Announcements convert his audience trust into product awareness. ~1 in 4 posts touches lemlist, but rarely as the subject — usually as the last bullet or a "that's what we do at lemlist" proof point.
- **Engagement tactics:** end-of-post binary questions; deliberately polarizing openers on RTO/AI/media; reacting to well-known brands (borrowed reach); French-language emotional posts for shares; tagging real people (Guillaume, Claap founders) to pull their networks in.

Differentiation & verdict

- **Differentiator:** He's an **operator, not a coach**. Where most cold-email/GTM creators sell tactics and templates, Tenot sells judgment and taste from having actually held CRO/CEO seats. The recurring "average X vs great X" and "poorly-performing vs top company" frames are his signature — pattern libraries of executive behavior.
- **What WORKS (evidence):** (1) Contrarian one-liner + mirrored lists is his most reliable 800–1,300-like format. (2) **Cold-email teardowns punch way above weight** — tiny volume, median 250 / mean 447 likes, and #2 overall at 1,310. (3) Named-brand hot-takes maximize comments (Deel 190, Klarna 116). (4) Emotional/cause stories maximize shares (Poulpi 52). (5) Announcements framed as *vision* (coining "Smartbound") hold ~150 median, above baseline.
- **What HASN'T worked as well:** deliverability-infra (median 68) and pure metrics-benchmarks (median 114, mean only 105) underperform — audience wants the executive worldview, not plumbing. Straight product features without a personal or contrarian wrapper sink toward the 130 baseline.
- **What he AVOIDS:** downloadable lead magnets, "comment for the doc" bait, step-by-step how-tos, hard sales CTAs, lowercase/hooky broetry gimmicks (his voice is grammatically clean, direct, executive), and self-promotion as the post's subject.

Steal for Taha (cold-email / outbound, build-in-public)

1. **Run the "I got 1,000 cold emails, I replied to one" teardown format.** It's his single most efficient post (1,310 likes from a tiny content category). Taha has the exact raw material — real prospecting emails hitting Bleed AI inboxes. Post a real winner, arrow-list *why* it worked, then "here's how I'd make it even better," and let the Bleed AI method be the implicit answer. Value-first, product-plug-last.
2. **Lead with operator credibility + a contrarian one-liner, not a tactic.** Tenot's biggest hits are complete, debatable claims in line one. For build-in-public, Taha's version: bold claims about outbound reality ("Volume outbound is dead — I get 1,000 emails a month and reply to one") backed by his own agency data, closed with "Agree? Disagree?" to farm comments.
3. **Coin and own a category / point-of-view, not a feature.** Tenot reframes lemlist+Claap as "Smartbound — timing over volume." Taha should package Bleed AI's approach under one repeatable named POV (signal-based / trigger-based outbound) and repeat it, so every announcement reinforces one worldview.
4. **Use the mirrored-list template as a content engine.** "The average SDR vs the great SDR," "poorly-performing outbound teams vs top ones." Cheap to produce, highly shareable, and each one positions Bleed AI as the "great" column — exactly how Tenot smuggles lemlist into the last bullet without it feeling like an ad.

eric-nowoslawski — Founder of Growth Engine X; the "Clay + Claude Code" cold-email operator (YouTube-only in corpus)

DATA CAVEAT: `_tagged.jsonl` has **zero** LinkedIn rows for `eric-nowoslawski` — the only corpus is his **YouTube** channel (54 transcripts + 256 video metadata entries). So this report is ranked by **YouTube views**, not likes. (Note: he is the same person as `outboundphd` — this YouTube profile complements that LinkedIn report; treat them together.)

Snapshot: 54 transcribed videos (256 total) · **median 2,100 views** · **mean 3,141** · **max 24,000** · **min 684** · window Jul 2025–Jun 2026 · domains: cold-email ops, Clay enrichment, AI/agent GTM automation (Claude Code, Cursor, Codex), deliverability, list-building · format: almost entirely long-form screen-share tutorials + "here's my data / here's what works" teardowns (10–29 min). Recurring title formulas: "Claude Code + X Destroys Y," "I sent/tested N emails, here's what works," "Copy/Steal this."

Top 5 content pillars (ranked 1–5)

1. **AI-agent GTM automation (Claude Code / Cursor / Codex / skills / auto-research)** — ~20 of 54 videos, **share ≈ 37%, median ≈ 2,350 views** but owns both mega-hits (24k, 17k). Sub-themes: Claude "skills" as shareable SOPs, Sonnet sub-agents to do ICP-filtering "without spending AI tokens," Karpathy-style "auto-research" loops that self-optimize campaigns for positive-reply-rate.
2. **Cold-email fundamentals & deliverability** — sequences, domains, inbox burn, benchmarks. ~10 videos, **share ≈ 18%, median ≈ 2,700 views**. Anchored by "How I Would Start Over" (5,800) and "I sent 10,000,000 cold emails" (5,800).
3. **Clay enrichment & signal/alpha building (Claygent, golden ICP, GTM alpha)** — ~9 videos, **share ≈ 17%, median ≈ 1,900**. Ex-Clay ("their largest user"), so authority turf.
4. **Campaign strategy, copy & offers (the "Creative Ideas" campaign, CTAs, personalization)** — ~7 videos, **share ≈ 12%, median ≈ 1,600**. His single most-repeated tactical playbook.
5. **List-building & data sourcing (Prospero, Sales Nav, Google Maps, scraping)** — ~6 videos, **share ≈ 11%, median ≈ 1,900**.

Top 10 videos (by views)

1. **"Claude Code Just Changed Lead Generation Forever" — 24,000 views** · Claude Code for end-to-end lead-gen. HOOK: "There's an AI tool that can build your entire cold email lead generation system." Structure: promise 4 things up front → live-build each with WhisperFlow voice prompts → tease enterprise auto-research. Tone: breathless evangelist.

2. **"Claude Code + Karpathy Destroys Every Lead Gen Agency"** — 17,000 · self-optimizing reply-rate loop. HOOK: *"Cloud Code plus Karpathy are about to destroy every lead gen agency in the next 12 months, including ours."* Results first (20.71 vs 10.71 replies/1k) → give away repo → free-first-campaign CTA. Tone: provocative doom-hook, radical transparency.
3. **"Find Anyone's Email With Claude Code"** — 6,600 · cheap email-permutation guesser. HOOK: *"...how you can use Cloud Code to build your own email finding tool as cheap as possible."* Tone: teacherly, demystifying.
4. **"Copy These Claude Skills, They'll Blow Up Your Business"** — 6,500 · his [cold-outbound-skills](#) repo. HOOK: *"There's a system entirely built inside Claude code that can do everything for you... without spending any of your own AI tokens."* Tone: generous flex, "buy-in at every step."
5. **"Claude Code + Clay.com = Unlimited Qualified Leads"** — 6,100 · auto-pull ICP → score → push to SmartLead. HOOK: *"Most people I speak to are still generating leads the old-fashioned way... downloading CSVs."* Tone: pain-agitation into demo.
6. **"How I Would Start Over Again in Cold Email"** — 5,800 · 3 pillars (sending/list/message) + what to ignore. HOOK: *"If I had to start cold email all over again, what would I do?"* Tone: seasoned veteran.
7. **"I sent 10,000,000 cold emails, here's what works in 2025"** — 5,800 · 29-min lesson-dump. HOOK: *"Did you think cold email was going to be easy? I know I did."* ~15 stacked mini-lessons. Tone: war-stories mentor.
8. **"How We Send 8M Cold Emails/Month with Claude and Clay.com"** — 4,700 · architecture deep-dive (Prospero→Supabase→waterfall→Clay). Tone: ops-nerd transparency.
9. **"I Tested 500,000 Cold Email, This Is The Best Campaign"** — 4,400 · the **"Creative Ideas"** campaign (3 constrained AI-personalized plays). HOOK: *"...the answer is always extremely simple."* Tone: confident "this is THE one."
10. **"Inside Our Claude Code Google Maps Lead System"** — 4,000 · owner+email finder for local/no-LinkedIn businesses. Tone: experiment-in-public.

Top 5 contrarian takes

1. **"Throw the domain away."** *"2 years ago I'd say let it warm up 45 days. In today's spam-cannon environment, throw it away. Any effort to fix a \$12 domain with a \$6 inbox is a waste."*
2. **Stop following up — 2 emails beats 3+.** *"Email one is the top performing email across all our customer sequences... past the third email the performance drops like crazy."*
3. **Kill generic AI personalization.** *"Hey I saw you sell to fitness coaches'... generic AI personalization got 143% less replies. I was a big proponent in 2024... never do this again."*
4. **Don't name your case studies.** *"Naming case studies correlated with average and below-average campaigns; just explaining how you helped another company correlated with excellent."*
5. **Open-rate tracking isn't the boogeyman + send the image if it converts.** *"People made tracking open rates the boogeyman when it's a really great way to know if you're landing in the inbox." And: "if the image increases response rate but lowers deliverability, send the image — it nets out to worth it."*

End-to-end strategy

- **Cadence:** ~1 video/week stated; actual run-rate heavier (256 videos, repurposed course/webinar chunks). Content is **educational tutorial, never lifestyle** — every title is a specific promise or a named tool.
- **Format mix:** long screen-shares (live Claude Code / Clay builds, 11–29 min) + data-teardown monologues. Uses WhisperFlow voice-prompting on-camera on purpose.
- **Hooks:** (a) **tool-name + destruction verb** ("Claude Code + Karpathy **Destroys** Every Lead Gen Agency"); (b) **big number as proof** ("I sent 10,000,000," "8M/month," "1,517 campaigns → 44,426 positive responses"). Frequently self-includes in the threat ("...including ours").
- **CTA / lead-magnet mechanics:** the recurring monetization CTA is **"we always launch your first campaign for free"** — risk-reversal, gated to *"B2B business owner over \$3M revenue with a sales team that doesn't have enough leads."* Content CTA = **repo giveaways** (GitHub [cold-outbound-skills](#)) — "paste this link into Claude Code." He also teaches lead-magnet CTA hygiene: *"tie the lead magnet to the call."*

- **Funnel / monetization:** YouTube authority → free repos/skills → **free first campaign** → done-for-you agency (Growth Engine X). Also monetizes proximity: runs outbound *for* Clay/Instantly, then uses them as case studies.
- **Engagement tactics:** invites comments as data requests ("*leave a comment of what you want me to look at, I'll send another Claude Code agent*"); answers Slack-community questions on-camera; radical-transparency numbers; "steal this / copy this."

Differentiation & verdict

- **Differentiator:** the only creator here at the **Clay-insider × Claude-Code-builder** intersection. He sells **infrastructure and systems** (waterfalls, sub-agents, auto-research loops, a 20M-email Supabase cache), not "write better copy." Authority is operational and quantified (real API pulls, SmartLead reply-rate screenshots).
- **What WORKS (evidence):** AI-automation pillar produced his only breakout hits — **24,000 and 17,000 views vs a 2,100 median (10x+)**. The "tool-name + Destroys/Forever" hook + free-repo giveaway is his proven viral formula. Concrete proof: the "Creative Ideas" campaign as durable top-performer; sustainability-alpha ladder **1-in-650 → 1-in-250 → 1-in-120**; the free-test offer "blew out any increase we had from the AI."
- **What HASN'T (evidence):** deep-in-the-weeds tooling videos underperform — Cursor series (893–2,300), "Claygent vs Google vs ZenRows" (684), "Top 3 Metrics" (709). Narrow how-to without a big-number or "destroys" hook lands near the floor.
- **What he AVOIDS:** personal/lifestyle content, no-value hooks, tool-agnostic fluff. Refuses to over-promise full autonomy ("*you still approve every round*"), locks the CTA so AI can't give the product away free, and won't recommend "secret sauce" data/deliverability vendors.

Steal for Taha (cold-email/outbound + build-in-public)

1. **The "Creative Ideas" campaign is directly portable to Bleed AI.** Constrain AI to **3 fixed, real-capability bullets** ("*here's specifically how we'd help you*") rather than open-ended personalization; hand-write 3–4 gold examples so the model learns tone. He credits this as his #1 performer across every client type. Pair with his CTA finding: **"if we could help you with X, would that be useful?" beats "want to book a meeting?"**
2. **Build-in-public via giveaways = his growth engine, and it's replicable.** His biggest videos exist because he **gave away the repo/skills** and made "paste this link into Claude Code" the CTA. Taha could package a Bleed AI **cold-email skill or Clay-table template** as a public giveaway with the DFY upsell behind it.
3. **Lead with a big real number + a "destroys/forever" hook.** His view data is unambiguous: quantified-proof hooks and provocation drive 10x the median. Taha should mine Bleed AI's real campaign data for headline numbers and stop publishing narrow how-tos without a proof-hook.
4. **Adopt his deliverability + sequence defaults as cheap wins:** disposable domains (don't rehab), **2–3 emails max (email one is the best performer)**, cut generic AI personalization entirely (–143% replies), don't name unknown case-study logos, and **the free-first-campaign risk-reversal offer** — which he says out-performed every copy optimization he ever tried. That last one is the single highest-leverage steal for Bleed AI's own outbound.

Post links — every creator's top 15 posts (by likes)

Direct LinkedIn URLs for every top-post referenced above (ranked by likes; the top ~10 of each match the "Top 10 posts" lists in the reports). Format: **rank** · **likes** · **date** · **abstract**. (*eric-nowoslawski is YouTube-only in the corpus — his content lives at youtube.com/@growthenginex; the LinkedIn person is [outboundphd](#) above.*)

kenny-damian

1. **1267L** · 2025-09-12 · [Deploy 6 n8n AI agents \(37 agents for \\$6M ARR agency\)](#)
2. **1033L** · 2026-03-23 · [Claude Code cheat sheet \(600+ hours\)](#)
3. **871L** · 2026-03-16 · [Claude Code can prospect, enrich, write, launch](#)
4. **802L** · 2025-11-12 · [Claude builds 90% of enterprise n8n workflows](#)
5. **405L** · 2026-02-17 · [Open-sourced 15 Claude Code skills](#)
6. **380L** · 2025-02-26 · [Giving away n8n pre-sales-call research workflow](#)
7. **285L** · 2026-01-20 · [New position: Head of GTM at ColdIQ](#)
8. **208L** · 2026-02-27 · [1,400+ watched a live Claude Code build](#)
9. **195L** · 2026-03-02 · [We sent 1,000,000 cold emails — 6-step system](#)
10. **193L** · 2025-09-08 · [n8n workflow → HTML prospect dossier in <2 min](#)
11. **183L** · 2026-02-10 · [9-step cold email system](#)
12. **180L** · 2025-09-03 · [500 AI workflows across 70+ clients](#)
13. **175L** · 2025-11-06 · [GTM cheatsheet \(inbox/signals/timing\)](#)
14. **169L** · 2025-05-22 · [n8n workflow: find→enrich→GPT-score leads](#)
15. **163L** · 2025-02-18 · [n8n Google Maps email scraper](#)

sacha-martinot

1. **388L** · 2026-04-10 · [24/7 AI agent in 30 seconds \(Managed Agents\)](#)
2. **387L** · 2026-04-13 · [Built a LinkedIn Content Hub with Claude Code](#)
3. **274L** · 2026-04-21 · [AI agent scrapes Claude Code skills 24/7](#)
4. **164L** · 2026-05-27 · [How Anthropic engineers use Claude Code](#)
5. **125L** · 2026-04-09 · [13 free n8n workflows](#)
6. **109L** · 2026-02-20 · [7 Claude Code skills from \\$7M ARR agency](#)
7. **103L** · 2026-06-18 · [Dynamic Workflows came for n8n](#)
8. **101L** · 2026-06-03 · [Content Hub v2 \(rerun\)](#)
9. **93L** · 2026-04-15 · [Claude Code skills to write viral posts](#)
10. **90L** · 2026-06-17 · [Free skill-finder tool](#)
11. **80L** · 2026-05-07 · [AI agent builds landing pages](#)
12. **71L** · 2026-02-06 · [Joined ColdIQ, building with n8n/Cursor/Claude](#)

outboundphd (Eric Nowoslawski — LinkedIn)

1. **342L** · 2026-04-21 · [29 Claude skills repo \(free\)](#)
2. **307L** · 2025-01-08 · [Free 119-page cold email doc](#)
3. **297L** · 2025-11-19 · [Claude Skills replace knowledge-work](#)
4. **288L** · 2025-10-24 · [Clay silently released Derived Datapoints](#)
5. **269L** · 2025-01-22 · [Leaving Clay / unicorn raise](#)
6. **252L** · 2025-11-25 · [I was completely wrong about AI prompting \(caching\)](#)

7. **238L** · 2025-09-18 · [Founders and their dumb domain purchases](#)
8. **223L** · 2026-04-20 · [Claude Code doubled response rates in a week](#)
9. **217L** · 2025-05-12 · [How Arturo joined Clay \(story\)](#)
10. **217L** · 2026-05-04 · [Codex /goal auto-builds Clay tables](#)
11. **208L** · 2025-12-17 · [Every agency should cache data in Supabase](#)
12. **198L** · 2025-07-16 · [How I'd start over in cold email](#)

michel-lieben

1. **2794L** · 2025-04-21 · [4,000 emails → 1 lead → \\$4M ARR](#)
2. **1562L** · 2025-05-22 · [\\$400K MRR — every tool we use](#)
3. **1387L** · 2025-07-14 · [lemlist \\$34M ARR tool stack](#)
4. **1172L** · 2025-06-05 · [\\$4.8M/year funnel breakdown](#)
5. **1110L** · 2025-06-09 · [Most "AI agents" are just workflows](#)
6. **1039L** · 2026-05-18 · [Claude Design vs Claude Code \(giveaway\)](#)
7. **1027L** · 2025-07-22 · [lemlist \\$34M ARR funnel](#)
8. **876L** · 2025-07-21 · [How I'd find my first 10 B2B clients](#)
9. **796L** · 2025-11-19 · [Failed 7 businesses → \\$557K month](#)
10. **774L** · 2026-02-25 · [Run your GTM with Claude Code \(demo\)](#)
11. **759L** · 2026-04-16 · [Claude Code automates the full cold email pipeline](#)
12. **658L** · 2025-04-22 · [The SDR role is changing because of AI](#)

nick-abraham

1. **1257L** · 2025-06-28 · ["So you have \\$6,000 of monthly revenue?" \(Clay-spend dialogue\)](#)
2. **416L** · 2025-12-18 · [Lifetime agreement after 8 years](#)
3. **305L** · 2025-10-31 · [Part owner of Cleverly \(full circle\)](#)
4. **294L** · 2025-04-11 · [FREE similar-accounts tool — comment EMAIL](#)
5. **257L** · 2025-04-01 · [Free cold email frameworks master doc](#)
6. **247L** · 2026-02-17 · [Speed-to-lead website-visitor play](#)
7. **239L** · 2025-09-01 · [How different CEOs respond to cold emails](#)
8. **227L** · 2026-05-12 · [\\$30k debt → 300+ clients origin story](#)
9. **203L** · 2026-04-11 · [Vibecoded a \\$99/mo SaaS replacement](#)
10. **199L** · 2026-06-10 · [>50% of outbound success is the follow-up](#)
11. **190L** · 2025-04-28 · ["Cold email doesn't work for my business." BS.](#)
12. **183L** · 2025-11-12 · [A barber's cold email teardown](#)

atishay-hyperke

1. **154L** · 2026-02-12 · [Cold email AI gem V2 \(comment V2\)](#)
2. **148L** · 2026-01-16 · [20M emails → Gemini 3 writes them better](#)
3. **146L** · 2026-06-24 · [Free GTM engineer field manual](#)
4. **129L** · 2026-04-08 · [4:51am Phi Phi / Smartescape retreat](#)
5. **122L** · 2026-01-21 · [51 enterprise appointments \(Dow Jones/STUSSY\)](#)
6. **101L** · 2025-06-04 · [Cold-email evaluator GPT \(14,900 leads\)](#)
7. **100L** · 2026-01-05 · [10K/mo ≠ 100K/mo \(scaling money-math\)](#)
8. **99L** · 2026-05-11 · [65,419 emails in a saturated niche → 57 demos](#)

9. **95L** · 2026-05-23 · [2.6M cold emails in 14 days](#)
10. **89L** · 2026-06-25 · ["Googled the top 1%" origin story](#)

richard-illingworth

1. **171L** · 2025-11-13 · [Cold emails in 2025 meme](#)
2. **166L** · 2025-07-29 · [I studied Hormozi's cold outreach for 72h](#)
3. **156L** · 2026-02-26 · [I fed Claude Opus my \\$10M cold system](#)
4. **136L** · 2026-05-20 · ["Just pull a list from Apollo" — 7-method stack](#)
5. **133L** · 2025-07-11 · [Free SOP for agency owners](#)
6. **132L** · 2025-11-28 · ["Cold email is spam" — all sales is spam](#)
7. **129L** · 2025-06-16 · [Be your own best case study](#)
8. **126L** · 2025-06-27 · [I analyzed 237 cold email campaigns](#)
9. **125L** · 2025-08-20 · [90% of cold emails fail \(one-sentence pitch\)](#)
10. **121L** · 2026-03-09 · [250,000 inboxes — free full system](#)
11. **115L** · 2026-02-03 · [It's infra, not your copy](#)

nikita-maildoso

1. **283L** · 2025-03-27 · [Grow your agency with cold email \(Wes Foster live\)](#)
2. **273L** · 2026-04-20 · [300 free SMTP inboxes \("but f*k it"\)](#)
3. **253L** · 2026-04-07 · [Left Russia for Uruguay \(story\)](#)
4. **189L** · 2025-06-16 · ["Is Maildoso going bankrupt?" \(blacklist crisis\)](#)
5. **160L** · 2025-07-17 · [Links & images now safe in cold email](#)
6. **124L** · 2026-07-02 · [300 free inboxes "but there's one catch"](#)
7. **118L** · 2025-12-08 · [I got a cold email from Google](#)
8. **88L** · 2025-12-15 · [Blacklist crisis v2](#)

aidan-collins

1. **180L** · 2026-01-21 · [One concept beats 99% of LinkedIn](#)
2. **149L** · 2026-06-16 · [Claude Code + Reddit viral autopilot](#)
3. **98L** · 2026-06-29 · [27 sales calls in 48 hours \(packaging\)](#)
4. **97L** · 2026-05-04 · [45/35/10 DM funnel \(specificity\)](#)
5. **85L** · 2026-02-08 · ["Just be consistent" is the worst advice](#)
6. **79L** · 2026-06-19 · [12 best lead-magnet types](#)
7. **77L** · 2026-01-27 · [Client closed \\$42k with 5-10 likes/post](#)
8. **73L** · 2026-06-24 · [Same magnet, new image+hook = 20x comments](#)

josh-braun

1. **4442L** · 2026-02-05 · [My mom died yesterday](#)
2. **3608L** · 2025-08-12 · [Why high-performing reps leave](#)
3. **3213L** · 2026-05-04 · [Automation can't create a memory](#)
4. **3096L** · 2025-07-07 · [The Sunday-emails boss](#)
5. **2957L** · 2026-05-25 · [Why top reps leave \(rewrite\)](#)
6. **2903L** · 2025-09-19 · [The 6-year-old who ordered for the table](#)
7. **2419L** · 2025-09-11 · [The Starbucks pickup line](#)
8. **2212L** · 2026-05-17 · [I can't use an em dash anymore](#)

9. **2091L** · 2025-03-11 · [Sales volatility / detach from outcome](#)
10. **1680L** · 2025-03-20 · [Just say "Okay" and hang up](#)

charles-tenot

1. **1325L** · 2025-03-12 · [CRO is harder than CEO](#)
 2. **1310L** · 2025-07-09 · [1,000 emails, I replied to one \(teardown\)](#)
 3. **1164L** · 2025-01-29 · [Great vs average VP of Sales](#)
 4. **1128L** · 2025-02-05 · [Deel does \\$800M ARR, CRM still a mess](#)
 5. **1079L** · 2025-09-16 · [Lazy at home = lazy at the office](#)
 6. **858L** · 2025-02-18 · [The CRO who faked CRM notes \(7X\)](#)
 7. **844L** · 2025-07-21 · [Kindness in business \(Guillaume\)](#)
 8. **710L** · 2025-10-20 · [We bought Claap → "Smartbound"](#)
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WHY THEY WON vs WHY THEY FLOPPED — per creator (with worst-post links)

The universal pattern (across all 11):

- **Why winners win:** an authority/big-number or curiosity/contrarian hook in line 1 · a *real asset* given away behind a comment-KEYWORD-+-connect gate · riding the current AI/Claude-Code wave · before/after money-math · or an emotional story. All on-lane.
- **Why flops flop:** ❌ pure promo/event announcements with no takeaway · ❌ dry tactical how-to with no hook, number, or proof · ❌ off-lane topics (their non-core domain) · ❌ **no comment-gate/CTA** (for the lead-magnet operators, this is the biggest single killer) · ❌ generic "principle" posts with no specificity · ❌ posts too new to have accumulated distribution.

kenny-damian

Why the top 10 won: 1) 1267L authority-number ("37 AI agents / \$6M ARR") + named-agent list + giveaway · 2) 1033L "600+ hours" save-worthy cheat-sheet · 3) 871L Claude-Code end-to-end + gate · 4) 802L capability-news ("builds 90% of n8n") + comment "CLAUDE" · 5) 405L free 15-skills repo + gate · 6) 380L free n8n workflow + gate · 7) 285L native new-job template (social proof) · 8) 208L live-build event proof + "Webinar" gate · 9) 195L borrowed-scale ("1M emails so you don't have to") · 10) 193L ROI-first hook (\$10k saved). **Why the bottom 10 flopped:**

1. **20L** — [exact Email-1 structure](#) — dry copywriting how-to, his weakest lane, no gate/flex.
2. **20L** — [intent-led outbound take](#) — opinion, not an asset; audience wants tools.
3. **23L** — [alt sales triggers](#) — dry tactic, no build/gate.
4. **24L** — [20 cold-email changes](#) — generic listicle, no proof-number hook.
5. **25L** — [7 copywriting tips](#) — commodity tips, weakest pillar.
6. **29L** — [LinkedIn DM SOP](#) — off-lane (LinkedIn meta), no tooling flex.
7. **29L** — [350 followers in 24h](#) — LinkedIn-content meta, off his AI lane.
8. **33L** — [MCP explainer](#) — educational, no asset/gate.
9. **33L** — [4-step lead framework](#) — dry framework, no gate.
10. **33L** — [5 deliverability fixes](#) — dry infra how-to, no flex.

sacha-martinot

Why the top 10 won: round-number specificity ("13 tools," "7 skills," "24/7 in 30s") + authority anchor ("\$7M ARR agency," "Anthropic engineers") + a *built thing* + comment-gate; news-jacking every Claude release first. **Why the bottom 10 flopped:**

1. **15L** — [LinkedIn Ads mistakes / plugin](#) — ColdIQ promo, act=none, no personal build angle.
2. **16L** — [Clay-credit plugin](#) — narrow "parts-list" tactic, not a shiny built thing.
3. **18L** — [agents are your best customer](#) — abstract opinion, no asset.
4. **21L** — [6 APIs the top 1% run on](#) — parts-list, no built demo.
5. **27L** — [build a 24/7 agent \(rehash\)](#) — a rehash of his hit, novelty spent.
6. **27L** — [5 skills or 10% of Claude Code](#) — scold-listicle, no giveaway.
7. **28L** — [ColdIQ hit \\$7M ARR](#) — pure promo, no build story.
8. **30L** — [3D render business idea](#) — off-lane (real estate), not his ICP.
9. **30L** — [30-sec GTM report](#) — teardown w/o proof or gate.
10. **31L** — [fitness/travel/retirement workflows](#) — off-lane personal automations.

outboundphd

Why the top 10 won: free high-value asset (repo/119-page doc) + comment-gate · "I was completely wrong" confession hooks · Clay-insider scoops ("Clay silently released...") · result-first ("doubled reply rates in a week"). **Why the bottom 10 flopped:**

1. **19L** — [Shawn's event promo](#) — pure third-party event promo, no value.
2. **22L** — [Dextegon Summit promo](#) — self-promo announcement, no takeaway.
3. **23L** — [Sculpt talk promo](#) — event announcement, no substance.
4. **23L** — [4o-mini LLM take](#) — narrow opinion, no asset.
5. **28L** — [2 AI workflows](#) — example-only, no gate/hook.
6. **29L** — [weekend multi-threading](#) — dry niche tactic.
7. **31L** — [praising TryKitt.ai](#) — off-lane shout-out, no value.
8. **31L** — [CES company list](#) — off-topic link dump.
9. **32L** — [Clay + Serper operators](#) — deep-weeds tactic, no proof-hook.
10. **33L** — [Porkbun domain sale](#) — pure deal-promo, no substance.

michel-lieben

Why the top 10 won: before/after money-math ("4,000 emails → \$4M ARR") · "here's every tool / our whole funnel" transparency · recyclable "agent = workflow" contrarian · comment-gated guides · pitch quarantined to a P.S. **Why the bottom 10 flopped:**

1. **26L** — [Instantly AI-outreach session](#) — early event promo, no hook.
2. **69L** — [find 70% of phone numbers](#) — narrow list-building tactic (his weak domain).
3. **76L** — [find a mobile number free](#) — tiny one-tool tip, low signal.
4. **108L** — [reverse-engineer case studies](#) — abstract principle, no stack reveal.
5. **111L** — [Unify 188-meetings session](#) — webinar promo, not a teardown.
6. **114L** — [hiring a content designer](#) — recruiting post, no audience value.
7. **116L** — [pick our new logo](#) — low-value engagement-bait.
8. **123L** — [why I won't hire you](#) — hiring-opinion, off the "show the machine" formula.
9. **125L** — [\\$1 lead-gen course promo](#) — early promo, naked sell.
10. **129L** — [145 leads in 3 months](#) — case-study without the big-number/before-after hook.

nick-abraham

Why the top 10 won: a *device* (fake dialogue, quote-ladder, real-email teardown) · comment "EMAIL" (must-be-connected) giveaways · vulnerable origin/milestone stories · brevity. **Why the bottom 10 flopped:**

1. **10L** — [13 cold-email templates carousel](#) — a plain giveaway with **no comment-gate** — the mechanic was off.
2. **12L** — [email-to-lead ratio framework](#) — dry agency-ops framework, no device.
3. **16L** — [list-building validation](#) — dry how-to, no hook.
4. **16L** — [Sam Altman should learn from gurus](#) — off-lane hot-take, no payoff.
5. **17L** — [tattoo cold-email joke](#) — low-effort meme, no substance.
6. **18L** — [agency cashflow tips](#) — off-topic (finance), dry.
7. **18L** — [build an LMS](#) — internal-ops framework, off ICP.
8. **19L** — [avoid missed personalization](#) — generic copy-principle.
9. **19L** — [partnership campaigns](#) — dry framework, niche.
10. **19L** — [offer + downsell](#) — dry framework, no device/gate.

atishay-hyperke

Why the top 10 won: credential-shock ("20M emails") + big-number case studies (named enterprise logos) + reusable AI-Gem behind a comment-keyword gate + money-math. **Why the bottom 10 flopped:**

1. **1L** — [empty activity post](#) — no text/hook at all.
2. **4L** — [GPT fear-desire angles](#) — early dry tactic, no proof/gate.
3. **4L** — [PS-line personalization](#) — micro-tip, no hook.
4. **5L** — [hospitality niche take](#) — narrow opinion, no proof-number.
5. **6L** — [empty mindset post](#) — no substance.
6. **6L** — [emails fail because they guess](#) — generic principle, no asset.
7. **7L** — [offers by credibility](#) — abstract, no proof.
8. **7L** — [AI for segmentation not copy](#) — principle, no gate/number.
9. **7L** — [SMB outbound teardown](#) — teardown promise, no payoff/gate.
10. **8L** — [test lead-magnet titles first](#) — meta-tip, no asset.

richard-illingworth

Why the top 10 won: myth-in-quotes + reversal · borrowed authority (Hormozi, Claude Opus) · number-proof ("237 campaigns," "250k inboxes") · comment-keyword + connect gate; memes for reach. **Why the bottom 10 flopped:**

1. **0L** — ["we send 500k/month"](#) — vague personal, no hook or payoff.
2. **2L** — [emails feel like a barge-in](#) — dry principle, his low-median filler.
3. **2L** — [5 follow-up mistakes](#) — generic listicle, no asset/gate.
4. **2L** — [most advice is useless](#) — vague hot-take, no specificity.
5. **2L** — [competitor killed your deliverability](#) — narrow infra principle.
6. **3L** — [it's data, not infra](#) — thin principle, off his own thesis.
7. **3L** — [TOOLS Notion giveaway](#) — a gated giveaway that still didn't land (weak hook).
8. **3L** — [templates trigger ESP matching](#) — dry deliverability principle.
9. **4L** — [licensed vs random inboxes](#) — deep-weeds infra, low interest.
10. **4L** — [deliverability is positioning](#) — abstract mindset take.

nikita-maildoso

Why the top 10 won: shameful-catch parenthetical + free-inbox giveaway + connect · crisis transparency · borrowed authority (Eric) · non-product personal stories. **Why the bottom 10 flopped:**

1. **4L** — [2026 GTME tech stack claim](#) — vague claim, no hook/asset.
2. **8L** — [lead-gen live session promo](#) — event promo, no takeaway.
3. **10L** — [ABM live session](#) — event promo.
4. **10L** — [cold-email setup live](#) — event promo, no substance in-post.
5. **11L** — [is SF overrated](#) — off-topic personal, no business hook.
6. **11L** — [turn HTML off](#) — dry deliverability tactic, no gate.
7. **11L** — [Kipplo 2.1 demo](#) — bare product promo.
8. **11L** — ["see you in a few minutes"](#) — empty reminder post.
9. **14L** — [avoid cheeky openers](#) — generic principle.
10. **15L** — [A/B/C/D/E/F + spintax](#) — deep-weeds tactic, no gate.

aidan-collins

Why the top 10 won: quoted-objection or exact-number hook + "(steal it free)" + comment-KEYWORD + connect. The gate *is* the engine. **Why the bottom 10 flopped (note: nearly ALL have NO comment-gate — proving his own thesis):**

1. **2L** — [7 post types swipe file](#) — low-key CTA, weak hook.
2. **2L** — [posting = top 1%](#) — generic principle, no magnet.
3. **2L** — [LinkedIn growth isn't instant](#) — value-post, no gate.
4. **2L** — [stop avoiding marketing tactics](#) — opinion, no asset.
5. **2L** — [S-Tier client framework](#) — story-principle, no magnet.
6. **3L** — [7-step call funnel](#) — announcement, weak/absent gate.
7. **3L** — [psychological signaling](#) — principle, no asset.
8. **3L** — [AI automation sucks on LinkedIn](#) — opinion, no magnet.
9. **3L** — [62-day content+DM system](#) — case-study, weak hook/gate.
10. **3L** — [client acquisition 101](#) — listicle-principle, no magnet.

josh-braun

Why the top 10 won: a non-business scene/confession hook → one-line sales principle; emotional parables (family, grievances); recyclable winners. **Why the bottom 10 flopped:**

1. **1L** — [discount-request reframe](#) — very recent (low distribution) + dry tactic.
2. **3L** — [replace "help" with "support"](#) — micro copy-tip, no story.
3. **5L** — [knowledge-gap questions](#) — dry framework, no parable.
4. **6L** — [features vs benefits](#) — commodity copy-tip.
5. **6L** — [pop-quiz on questions](#) — dry tactical listicle.
6. **6L** — [live with Jason Hill](#) — bare event promo.
7. **7L** — [courses vs YouTube](#) — soft product promo.
8. **8L** — [pause vs react muscle](#) — abstract mindset, no scene.
9. **9L** — [change sales-call intent](#) — recent + dry principle.
10. **9L** — [attention on the observer](#) — abstract mindfulness, off sales lane.

charles-tenot

Why the top 10 won: a complete debatable claim in line 1 (credential-flex, big-number contrast, named-brand reaction) + mirrored "average vs great" lists + "Agree? Disagree?". **Why the bottom 10 flopped:**

1. **12L** — [looking for next job](#) — personal life-update, no worldview/value.
2. **34L** — [track meeting time not MQLs](#) — dry metrics take (his weak domain).
3. **47L** — [Deliverability Hub launch](#) — product announcement, act=none, off his worldview lane.
4. **47L** — [good vs bad investors](#) — niche take, not audience-relevant.
5. **47L** — [make the unshiny shiny](#) — abstract principle.
6. **48L** — [Ramp/Perplexity GTM event](#) — event promo.
7. **48L** — [copying best practices harms](#) — generic principle, no hook.
8. **50L** — [marketing = motivation](#) — abstract theory.
9. **51L** — [measure training impact](#) — dry ops take.
10. **52L** — [SaaS most at risk from AI](#) — analytical take without a debate-hook.

The lesson for Taha (from the flops): the fastest way to *fail* is exactly what his account does now — post dry tactical tips or announcements with **no hook, no proof-number, and no comment-gate**, off a consistent lane. The winners are

never the smartest post; they're the one with a **big-number/curiosity/contrarian hook + a real gated asset, on-lane.**